DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE (DoD)
SMALL BUSINESS INNOVATION RESEARCH (SBIR)

SBIR X25.5 Annual Program Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO)

Table of Contents

I. INTRODUCTION 4

a. Program on Innovation Open Topics 4

b. Topic Release Instructions and Open Topic Solicitation Methodology 4

II. PROGRAM DESCRIPTION 4

a. Three-Phased Program 4

b. Eligibility and Performance Requirements 5

i. Applicant Must Qualify as a Small Business Concern 5

ii. Performance of Work Requirements 5

iii. Primary Employment of the Principal Investigator 5

iv. Location of the Work 5

c. Ownership by Multiple Venture Capital Operating Companies (VCOCs), Hedge Funds, and Private Equity Firms 6

d. Performance Benchmark Requirements/Increased Minimum Performance Standards for Experienced Firms 6

e. Direct to Phase II (D2P2) Proposal Standards 6

f. Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA) 7

g. State and Other Available Assistance 7

h. Fraud and Fraud Reporting 7

III. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION 7

a. DSIP Submission 7

b. Effect of Deadlines 8

c. Proposal Volumes 8

i. Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1) 8

ii. Technical Volume Format & Content (Volume 2) 8

iii. Cost Volume (Volume 3) 8

iv. Company Commercialization Report (Volume 4) 8

v. Supporting Documents (Volume 5) 10

vi. Fraud, Waste, and Abuse (FWA) Training (Volume 6) 10

vii. Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7) 10

d. DSIP Support 11

e. Export-Controlled Technologies 11

f. Classified Proposals 11
g. Promotional Materials 12
h. Prior, Current, or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards 12
i. Technical Baseline 12
j. Treatment of Commercial Off-the-Shelf (COTS) and Non-Developmental Items (NDIs) 12
k. Use of Commercial Item Procedures 12
l. Marking Proprietary Proposal Information 13
IV. CERTIFICATIONS AND REGISTRATIONS 13
a. System for Award Management (SAM) Registration 13
b. SBA Company Registry 13
c. Defense SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) Registration 13
d. Required Certifications 14
e. Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks 14
f. Joint Ventures 15
g. Conflicts of Interest 15
h. Research Involving Human Subjects/Human Subject Research (RIHS/RHS) 16
i. Research Involving Recombinant DNA Molecules 17
j. Use of Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) 17
k. Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act Orders 17
V. MISCELLANEOUS INFORMATION 18
a. Award Information 18
b. Fee or Profit 18
c. Payment Milestones 18
d. Contractual Requirements 18
i. Standards of Work 18
ii. Inspection 18
iii. Examination of Records 18
iv. Termination For Cause 18
v. Termination for Convenience 18
vi. Disputes 18
vii. Contract/OT Work Hours 18
viii. Equal Opportunity 18
ix. Affirmative Action for Veterans 18
x. Affirmative Action for Handicapped Individuals 18
xi. Officials Not to Benefit 19
xii. Covenant Against Contingent Fees 19

xiii. Gratuities 19
xiv. Patent Infringement 19
xv. Military Security Requirements 19
xvi. American-Made Equipment and Products 19
xvii. Unique Identification (UID) 19
xviii. Publication Approval/Disclosure of Information 19
xix. Animal Welfare 19
xx. Protection of Human Subjects 19
xxi. E-Verify 20
xxii. Cybersecurity 20
xxiii. Safeguarding Covered Defense Information Control 20
xxiv. Limitations on the Use or Disclosure of Third- Party Contractor Reported Cyber Incident Information 20
xxv. Basic Safeguarding of Covered Contractor Information Systems 20
xxvi. Prohibition on Contracting with Persons Who Have Business Operations with the Maduro Regime 20
xxvii. Prohibition on a ByteDance Covered Application 20
e. Agency Recovery and Ongoing Reporting 20
f. Copyrights 21
g. Patents 21
h. Invention Reporting 21
i. Technical Data Rights 21
j. Multiple Procurements Planned 21
k. Treatment of Proposals Received 22
l. CSO, Selection, and Award Protests 22
m. Technical Questions Related to Prospective Applicant Proposed Technical Solution 22
VI. APPENDIX A: DEFINITIONS 22

I. INTRODUCTION

a. Program on Innovation Open Topics

15 U.S.C. §638 (ww) requires DOD to establish innovation open topic activities to:

- increase the transition of commercial technology to the DoD;
- expand the small business nontraditional industrial base;
- increase commercialization derived from DoD investments; and
- expand the ability for qualifying SBCs to propose technology solutions to meet DoD needs.

Unlike conventional topics, which specify the desired technical objective and output, open topics use generalized mission requirements or specific technology areas to adapt commercial products or solutions to close capability gaps, improve performance, or provide technological advancements in existing capabilities.

Unless otherwise noted in the topic, an SBC may only submit one proposal to each open topic. If an SBC submits more than one proposal for a single open topic, only the most recent certified proposal submitted prior to the submission deadline will receive an evaluation. All previously submitted proposals for the same open topic will be marked nonresponsive and will not receive an evaluation.

b. Topic Release Instructions and Open Topic Solicitation Methodology

DoD Services and Components may elect to release open topics under this CSO once a month throughout fiscal year 2025. New open topics will be published on the first Wednesday of the month, with proposal open and close dates clearly stated within the Topic Release Instructions.

The instructions contained in this CSO are applicable to all subsequent releases. Additional instructions specific to an individual Topic Release will be contained within the Topic Release Instructions. Each release will have corresponding open and close dates applicable only to those topics contained within the release. **The DoD will accept proposals only in response to specified topic calls.**

II. PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

a. Three-Phased Program

The SBIR Program is a three-phase program. The purpose of **Phase I** is to determine, to the extent possible, the scientific, technical, and commercial merit and feasibility of ideas submitted under the SBIR Program. Phase I awards are made in accordance with the SBA Policy Directive guidelines, current version. The period of performance is *generally* between six to twelve months with twelve months being the maximum period allowable. Proposals should concentrate on research or research and development which will significantly contribute to proving the scientific and technical feasibility, and commercialization potential of the proposed effort, the successful completion of which is a prerequisite for further DoD support in Phase II. Proposing small business concerns are encouraged to consider whether the research or research and development being proposed to DoD Components also has private sector potential, either for the proposed application or as a base for other applications.

Phase II awards will be made to proposing small business concerns (SBCs) based on the results of their Phase I effort and/or the scientific merit, technical merit, or commercialization potential of a Phase II proposal. Phase II awards are made in accordance with the SBA Policy Directive guidelines, current version. The period of performance is *generally* 24 months. Phase II is the principal research or research and development effort and is expected to produce a well-defined deliverable prototype. A Phase II contractor may receive up to one additional, sequential Phase II award for continued work on the project.

Under 15 U.S.C. §638(cc), as amended by NDAA FY12, Sec. 5106, and further amended by NDAA FY19, Sec. 854, PILOT TO ALLOW PHASE FLEXIBILITY, the DoD may issue Phase II SBIR awards to SBCs that did not receive a Phase I SBIR/STTR award for the R/R&D proposed to the agency for funding. Such awards are referred to as Direct-to-Phase-II (D2P2) awards. The DoD makes D2P2 awards by means of clearly-designated D2P2 solicitation topics. These topics accept only D2P2 proposals. These topics result only in D2P2 awards. **The DoD does not accept Phase I proposals for D2P2 topics, and does not accept D2P2 proposals for Phase I topics.**

Under **Phase III**, the proposing SBC is required to obtain funding from either the private sector, a non-SBIR Government source, or both, to develop the prototype into a viable product or non-R&D service for sale in military or private sector markets. SBIR Phase III refers to work that derives from, extends, or completes an effort made under prior SBIR funding agreements, but is funded by sources other than the SBIR Program. Phase III work is typically oriented towards commercialization of SBIR research or technology.

b. Eligibility and Performance Requirements

i. Applicant Must Qualify as a Small Business Concern

Each proposing small business concern must qualify as a small business concern as defined by 13 C.F.R §§ 701-705 at time of award and certify to this in the Cover Sheet (Volume I) section of the proposal. The eligibility requirements for the SBIR/STTR programs are unique and do not correspond to those of other small business programs. Proposing small business concerns must meet eligibility requirements for Small Business Ownership and Control (see 13 CFR § 121.702)

ii. Performance of Work Requirements

A minimum of two-thirds (67%) of the research and/or analytical work in Phase I must be conducted by the proposing Small Business Concern. For Phase II, a minimum of one-half (50%) of the research and/or analytical work must be performed by the proposing small business concern. The percentage of work is measured by both direct and indirect costs. Occasionally, deviations from these SBIR requirements may occur, and must be approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer after consultation with the agency SBIR/STTR program manager/coordinator.

Note About Proposal Submission: The amounts listed in the Percentage of Work (POW) certification question on the proposal Cover Sheet (Volume I) are derived from SBC-entered information in the Cost Volume (Volume III). Details on the calculation can be viewed in DSIP during proposal submission. If the POW calculations fall below eligibility requirements, the applicant must request an explanatory letter from the DOD SBIR/STTR Contracting officer in order to complete the submission. Approval to **submit** a proposal that deviates from the prescribed POW requirements and Funding Agreement Officer **approval of the proposed deviation** are distinct approvals.

iii. Primary Employment of the Principal Investigator

For both Phase I and II, the primary employment of the principal investigator must be with the proposing small business concern at the time of the award and during the conduct of the proposed effort. Primary employment means that more than one-half of the principal investigator's time is spent with the small business. Primary employment with a small business concern precludes full-time employment at another organization.

iv. Location of the Work

For both Phase I and Phase II, all research or research and development work must be performed by the small business concern and its subcontractors in the United States. Based on a **rare and unique circumstance**, the DOD may approve a particular portion of the R/R&D work to be performed or

obtained in a country outside of the United States. For example, if a supply or material or other item or project requirement is not available in the United States.

c. Ownership by Multiple Venture Capital Operating Companies (VCOCs), Hedge Funds, and Private Equity Firms

Proposing small business concerns that are owned in majority part by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOCs), hedge funds, or private equity funds are eligible to submit applications and receive awards under this CSO. Any proposing small business concern that is owned, in whole or in part, by any VCOC, hedge fund, and/or private equity fund must identify each foreign national, foreign entity, foreign person, or foreign government holding or controlling greater than a 5% equity stake in the proposing small business concern, whether such equity stake is directly or indirectly held. The proposing small business concern must also identify any and all of its ultimate parent owner(s) and any other entities and/or individuals owning more than a 5% equity stake in its chain of ownership.

See Topic Release Instructions evaluation criteria for additional information regarding SBCs owned in majority part by multiple VCOCs, hedge funds, or private equity firms.

d. Performance Benchmark Requirements/Increased Minimum Performance Standards for Experienced Firms

Applicants with multiple prior SBIR/STTR awards must meet minimum performance requirements to be eligible to apply for a new Phase I or Direct-to-Phase II award. The Phase I to Phase II Transition Rate addresses the extent to which an awardee progresses a project from Phase I to Phase II. The Commercialization Benchmark addresses the extent to which an awardee has moved past Phase II work towards commercialization.

The SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Pub. L. 117-183) amended the benchmarks' application for more experienced firms. Find detailed information on benchmark calculations, increased performance standards for more experienced firms and consequence of failure to meet benchmarks here. SBA will notify companies failing either benchmark and the relevant officials at the participating agencies.

The SBIR/STTR Policy Directive defines the Departments of the Army, Navy, and Air Force each as its own federal agency, and the remaining DoD Components as an executive agency of the Department of Defense. Therefore, companies that fail to meet either of the benchmarks under the Increased Performance Standards for More Experienced Firms may not receive more than an overall total of 80 awards from DoD, as detailed in the breakdown below:

Army – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
Navy – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
Air Force – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards
All other DoD Components combined – 20 total Phase I and Direct to Phase II awards

In addition, SBA has posted a Guide to SBIR/STTR Program Eligibility to help small businesses understand program eligibility requirements, determine if they will be eligible at award, and accurately complete necessary certifications. Note, applicants are required to certify "Yes", "No", or "N/A" in DSIP Firm Certifications. Applicants who indicate that they are not eligible to participate may be disqualified.

Companies' benchmark information is not available to the public.

e. Direct to Phase II (D2P2) Proposal Standards

Awards under clearly-designated D2P2 topics will provide funds to conduct further R/R&D for non-defense commercial solutions to meet specific DOD end-users' and customers' needs. These D2P2

awards are intended to provide a commercialization path, and are not the proposed solutions' final step. Second phase commitments from non-SBIR Federal and non-Federal sources are not mandatory. Cost-share is also not required. However, second phase commitments may serve as commercial potential evidence in accordance with 15 USC 638(e)(4)(B)(ii). Applicants must adequately document completion of the Phase I feasibility requirement*.

Phase II proposals require a comprehensive, detailed effort description. Proposals should demonstrate sufficient technical progress or problem-solving results to warrant more extensive R/R&D. Developing technologies with commercial and military potential is extremely important. Particularly, DOD is seeking proposals emphasizing technologies' dual-use applications and commercialization.

*NOTE: The applicant shall provide information to enable the agency to make the 15 U.S.C. 638(cc) determination of scientific and technical feasibility and merit. Applicants are required to provide information demonstrating scientific and technical merit and feasibility has been established as part of the Technical Volume (Volume II). **Feasibility documentation cannot be based upon or logically extend from any prior or ongoing federally funded SBIR or STTR work.**

f. Discretionary Technical and Business Assistance (TABA)

The DOD does not offer TABA. Applicants shall not propose costs associated with TABA and such costs if proposed will not be accepted by the DOD.

g. State and Other Available Assistance

Many states have established programs to provide services to those proposing SBCs and individuals wishing to participate in the Federal SBIR Program. These services vary from state to state, but may include:

- Information and technical assistance;
- Matching funds to SBIR recipients;
- Assistance in obtaining Phase III funding.

SBCs may seek general administrative guidance from small and disadvantaged business utilization specialists located in various defense contract management activities throughout the continental United States.

h. Fraud and Fraud Reporting

Knowingly and willfully making any false, fictitious, or fraudulent statements or representations may be a felony under the Federal Criminal False Statement Act (18 U.S.C. Sec 1001), punishable by a fine of up to $10,000, up to five years in prison, or both. The DoD Office of Inspector General Hotline ("Defense Hotline") is an important avenue for reporting fraud, waste, abuse, and mismanagement within the DoD. The Office of Inspector General operates this hotline to receive and investigate complaints or information from contractor employees, DoD civilians, Service members, and the public. Individuals who wish to report fraud, waste or abuse may contact the Defense Hotline at (800) 424-9098 between 8:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. Eastern Time or visit their website to submit a complaint. Mailed correspondence should be addressed to the Defense Hotline, The Pentagon, Washington, DC 20301-1900, or email addressed to hotline@dodig.mil.

III. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

a. DSIP Submission

DSIP is the official portal for DoD SBIR/STTR proposal submission and its use is mandatory for all applicants and Government users. Applicants are required to submit proposals via DSIP; proposals submitted by any other means will be disregarded. Detailed guidance and Job Aids on DSIP proposal

submission are found here. Applicants are required to submit proposal documents into DSIP within the file size limitations indicated in DSIP.

b. Effect of Deadlines

Deadline for Receipt: Complete proposals must be certified and submitted in DSIP no later than the close date of the release listed on the Topic Release Instructions. Proposals cannot be submitted in the DSIP after the deadline is reached and will not be accepted or evaluated. No exceptions will be made to the submission deadline. DoD recommends early submission, as computer traffic intensifies near announcement closing. Do not wait until the end of the submission period to submit proposal materials. DOD is not responsible for missed proposal submission due to system lag or inaccessibility.

c. Proposal Volumes

The final proposal submission includes successful completion of all firm level forms, all required proposal volumes, and electronic corporate official certification. Firm-level forms include:

- Firm Certifications
- Audit Information
- Company Commercialization Report (which then becomes Volume 4)

Although signatures are not required on the electronic forms at the time of submission, the proposal must be certified electronically by the corporate official for it to be considered submitted. If the proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, the DOD program will contact the applicant for signatures prior to award. **Please plan to submit proposals as early as possible to allow time for troubleshooting any possible issues before the CSO close. DSIP Support is unable to assist with submission issues once a deadline has passed and cannot provide submission extensions. DoD is not responsible for missed proposal submission due to system latency.**

i. Proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1)

The proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1) is prepared on DSIP. The Cover Sheet (Volume 1) must include a brief technical abstract that describes the proposed R&D project and an anticipated benefits and potential commercial applications discussion. Each section should be no more than 3,000 characters.

Do not include proprietary or classified information in the proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1). If your proposal is selected for negotiation and possible award, the technical abstract and anticipated benefits discussion may be publicly released online. DSIP will assign a proposal number once the Cover Sheet (Volume 1) is saved. Applicants may modify the Cover Sheet (Volume 1) as needed until the Topic Release closes.

NOTE: the amounts listed in the percentage of work (POW) certification question on the proposal cover sheet are derived from SBC-entered information in the cost volume (Volume 3). Details on the calculation can be viewed in DSIP during proposal submission.

ii. Technical Volume Format & Content (Volume 2)

The technical volume format and content instructions will be addressed in the Topic Release Instructions.

iii. Cost Volume (Volume 3)

The cost volume format and instructions will be addressed in the Topic Release Instructions.

iv. Company Commercialization Report (Volume 4)

The Company Commercialization Report (CCR) allows companies to report funding outcomes resulting from prior SBIR and STTR awards. SBIR and STTR awardees are required by SBA to update and maintain their organization's CCR on SBIR.gov. Commercialization information is required upon

completion of the last deliverable under the funding agreement. Thereafter, SBIR and STTR awardees are requested to voluntarily update the information in the database annually for a minimum period of five years.

If the proposing firm has prior DoD and/or non-DoD Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, regardless of whether the project has any commercialization to date, a PDF of the CCR must be downloaded from SBIR.gov and uploaded to the Firm Forms section of DSIP by the Firm Admin. Firm Forms are completed by the DSIP Firm Admin and are applied across all proposals the firm submits. The DSIP CCR requirement is fulfilled by completing the following:

1. Log into the firm account at https://www.sbir.gov/.
2. Navigate to My Dashboard > My Documents to view or print the information currently contained in the Company Registry Commercialization Report.
3. Create or update the commercialization record, from the company dashboard, by scrolling to the "My Commercialization" section, and clicking the create/update Commercialization tab under "Current Report Version". Please refer to the "Instructions" and "Guide" documents contained in this section of the Dashboard for more detail on completing and updating the CCR. Ensure the report is certified and submitted.
4. Click the "Company Commercialization Report" PDF under the My Documents section of the dashboard to download a PDF of the CCR.
5. Upload the PDF of the CCR (downloaded from SBIR.gov in the previous step) to the Company Commercialization Report in the Firm Forms section of DSIP. This upload action must be completed by the Firm Admin.

In Volume 4 of the DSIP proposal submission, the applicant will be prompted to answer: "Do you have a new or revised Company Commercialization Report to upload?" There are three possible courses of action:

a. If the applicant has prior DoD and/or non-DoD Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards and **has a new or revised CCR from SBIR.gov to upload to DSIP**, select YES.
   1. If the user is the firm admin, they can upload the CCR PDF from SBIR.gov directly on this page. It will also be updated in the "Firm Forms" and be associated with all new or in-progress proposals the applicant submitted. If the user is not the firm admin, they will receive a message that they do not have access and must contact the firm admin to complete this action.
   2. **WARNING:** Uploading a new CCR under the DSIP "Firm Forms" section or clicking "Save" or "Submit" in one proposal's Volume 4 is considered a change for ALL proposals under any open BAAs or CSOs. If an applicant has previously certified and submitted any Phase I or Direct to Phase II proposals under ***any*** BAA or CSO ***still open***, those proposals will be automatically reopened. Applicant will have to recertify and resubmit affected proposals. If an applicant does not recertify or resubmit affected proposals, they will not be considered fully submitted and will not be evaluated.

b. If the applicant has prior DoD and/or non-DoD Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, and **no new or revised CCR from SBIR.gov to upload to DSIP**, select NO.
   1. If a prior CCR was uploaded to the "Firm Forms", the applicant will see a file dialog box at the bottom of the page and can view the previously uploaded CCR. This read-only access allows the applicant to confirm the firm admin uploaded the CCR.
   2. If no file dialog box appears at the bottom of the page **there is no previously uploaded CCR in the DSIP "Firm Forms**." To fulfill the DSIP CCR requirement the firm admin

must follow steps 1-5 listed above to download a CCR PDF from SBIR.gov and upload it to the DSIP "Firm Forms" to be included with all proposal submissions.

c. If the applicant has **NO** prior DoD and/or non-DoD Phase I and/or Phase II SBIR/STTR awards, the CCR upload from SBIR.gov is not required and SBC will select NO. The proposal's CCR section will be marked complete.

Please refer to the Topic Release Instructions for details on how the CCR information will be considered during proposal evaluations.

v. Supporting Documents (Volume 5)

Volume 5 is provided for applicants to submit additional documentation to support the Cover Sheet (Volume 1), Technical Volume (Volume 2), and the Cost Volume (Volume 3).

The following documents may be included in Volume 5, if applicable to the proposal. Refer to Topic Release Instructions for additional Volume 5 requirements.

Reminder: A completed proposal submission in DSIP does NOT indicate the mandatory supporting documents have been uploaded in accordance with the Topic Release Instructions.

- Letters of support
- Additional cost information
- Funding agreement certification
- Technical data rights (assertions)
- Lifecycle certification
- Allocation of rights
- Verification of Eligibility of Small Business Joint Ventures, if applicable
- DD Form 2345, Military Critical Technical Data Agreement, if applicable

vi. Fraud, Waste, and Abuse (FWA) Training (Volume 6)

FWA Training is required for DoD SBIR/STTR proposals. FWA training provides information on what represents FWA in the SBIR/STTR program, the most common mistakes that lead to FWA, as well as the penalties and ways to prevent FWA. The training currently consists of a 3-page PDF, consistent with the tutorial provided by the SBA. This training material must be thoroughly reviewed once per year and can be found here and in the DSIP proposal submission module for Volume 6. Plan time to review the tutorial during completion of Volume 6, prior to the proposal submission deadline. The individual designated as the Proposal Owner must complete this training on behalf of the applicant small business.

vii. Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries (Volume 7)

In accordance with 15 U.S.C. §638 (vv) and the SBA SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, the DoD will review all proposals submitted in response to this CSO to assess security risks of SBCs seeking a federally funded award. SBCs must complete the DSIP Volume 6 webform "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" (NOTE: PDF uploads are no longer accepted). The corporate official cannot certify and submit the full proposal until the Volume 6webform is fully completed and submitted.

Please be aware that the "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" form WILL NOT be accepted as a supporting document in DSIP's Volume 5 proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5.

d. DSIP Support

DSIP Support is unable to assist with submission issues once a deadline has passed and cannot provide submission extensions. If the proposal status is "In Progress" or "Ready to Certify" it will NOT be considered submitted, even if all volumes are added prior to the CSO close date. The proposing SBC may modify all proposal volumes prior to the Topic Release Instructions closing date.

The proposing SBC may modify all proposal volumes prior to the CSO closing date, however doing so will un-certify any previously certified and submitted proposal documents. Edited proposals will revert "In Progress" or "Ready to Certify" status and will not be considered submitted, even if all volumes are added prior to the Topic Release Instructions closing date.

DSIP Support Desk: Refer to the Customer Support Document at https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/api/public/download?uploadId=MTUzODQ1OA==&fileName=DSIP_Customer_Support_Document.pdf&showOnWeb=true for general information regarding the DoD SBIR/STTR process. For additional assistance with the DSIP application, please visit https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/learning-support/.

Email DSIP Support at DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com only for further assistance with issues pertaining directly to the DSIP application. Questions submitted to DSIP Support will be addressed in the order received during normal operating hours (Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. ET).

Applicants are responsible for following ALL troubleshooting guidance provided by DSIP Support. Applicants are responsible for reengaging with DSIP Support if provided troubleshooting tips do not resolve applicant proposal submission issues. Applicant proposal submission failure is rarely, if ever, attributable to DSIP performance issues.

e. Export-Controlled Technologies

DD Form 2345 - ITAR/EAR Certification: For proposals whose solutions fall under export- control regulations (either International Traffic in Arms (ITAR) or Export Administration Regulations (EAR)), a copy of the certified DD Form 2345, Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement, or evidence of application submission must be included. The form, instructions, and FAQs may be found at the United States/Canada Joint Certification Program website, http://www.dla.mil/HQ/InformationOperations/Offers/Products/LogisticsApplications/JCP/DD 2345Instructions.aspx. Approval of the DD Form 2345 will be verified if the proposal is chosen for award.

IAW DFARS 225.7901-4, Export Control Contract Clauses, the clause found at DFARS 252.225- 7048, Export-Controlled Items (June 2013), must be included in all solicitations and contracts; therefore, all awards resulting from this CSO will include DFARS 252.225-7048 or similar verbiage.

Note: for proposals whose solutions fall under export-control regulations, the Principal Investigator must be a U.S. citizen or lawful permanent resident.

f. Classified Proposals

Applicants may **not** submit classified proposals in response to this CSO. If efforts will require classified work during Phase II performance, the applicant must have or obtain a facility clearance.

Additional information on facility and personnel clearance procedures and requirements can be found at the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency site, http://www.dss.mil/index.html.

g. Promotional Materials

Promotional and non-project related proposal content is discouraged. Additional information provided via website or other communication medium, except where explicitly requested, will not be considered.

h. Prior, Current, or Pending Support of Similar Proposals or Awards

While it is permissible, with proposal notification, to submit identical proposals or proposals containing a significant amount of essentially equivalent work for consideration under numerous federal program solicitations, it is unlawful to enter negotiation for contracts requiring essentially equivalent effort. If there is any question concerning prior, current, or pending support of similar proposals or awards, it must be disclosed as early as possible and declared on the proposal Cover Sheet (Volume 1).

i. Technical Baseline

Department of the Air Force ONLY: As RDT&E programs, SBIR/STTR efforts are subject to scientific and technical literature searches in order to establish technical baseline, avoid duplication, and justify funding IAW AFI 61-201, Management of Scientific and Technical Information (STINFO) (29 January 2019) and AFRL/CA guidance, Streamlined and Waivered SBIR/STTR Specified Requirements (05 Aug 2019).

j. Treatment of Commercial Off-the-Shelf (COTS) and Non-Developmental Items (NDIs)

COTS/NDIs: Items purchased directly from a commercial source that can be utilized without alteration through design and development, or without modification, are classified as COTS or NDI. This includes, for example, ready-to-use products, training services, and software licenses for ready-to-use software to satisfy service needs (including Software as a Service (SaaS)).

Purchases of COTS and NDIs for use, including the first article and associated first article acceptance testing and related minor adjustments are not suitable for SBIR/STTR funding. The acquisition of commercial items or NDIs for testing and operational evaluation that do not require R/R&D engineering, design or integration effort will not be funded by SBIR/STTR funds. However, if an end item requires design and development in order to accept the COTS or NDI, funding for design and development effort could be funded by SBIR/STTR funds. If a COTS or NDI is required for RDT&E test purposes, the cost could be funded by SBIR/STTR funds.

Modified COTS/Modified NDIs: Commercially available items that must be modified to satisfy user requirements are classified as "modified COTS" or "modified NDI" articles. In this instance, the first article, modification of the first article, and first article testing could be funded by SBIR/STTR funds. Follow-on purchases will not be funded by SBIR/STTR funds. The number of “modified” first articles bought with SBIR/STTR funds will not exceed the quantity needed to conduct the RDT&E acceptance tests. Modification is technology refreshment significantly changing the end item’s performance envelope. If the commercially available item is modified and requires testing prior to approval for service use or inventory, it may be funded by SBIR/STTR funds, as all developmental items. In contrast to modification, continuous technology refreshment is the intentional insertion of newer technology to improve reliability, improve maintainability, reduce cost, and/or add minor performance enhancement, typically in conjunction with depot or field level maintenance. The insertion of such technology into end items as part of maintenance is not funded by SBIR/STTR funds.

k. Use of Commercial Item Procedures

The Government may acquire innovative commercial items, technologies, or services using a competitive procedure called a Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) using DFARS Subpart 212.70. Under a CSO, DoD may competitively select proposals received in response to a general solicitation, similar to a Broad Agency Announcement, based on proposal review by Government scientific, technological, or other subject-matter experts.

CSO use in accordance with DFARS Subpart 212.70 is considered competitive for the purposes of 10 U.S.C. chapter 127 and FAR 6.102. The DOD will treat items, technologies, and services acquired under this CSO as commercial items. The full definition of commercial items, i.e., products and services, under FAR 2.101 applies. This CSO includes no requirement for a commercial product or service to be an already-developed, off-the-shelf item.

l. Marking Proprietary Proposal Information

The DOD assumes no liability for disclosure or use of unmarked data and may use or disclose such data for any purpose. Restrictive notices notwithstanding, proposals and final reports submitted through DSIP may be handled, for administrative purposes only, by support contractors. All support contractors are bound by appropriate non-disclosure agreements.

Information contained in unsuccessful proposals will remain the property of the Applicant. The Federal Government may, however, retain copies of all proposals. Public release of information in any proposal submitted will be subject to existing statutory and regulatory requirements. If proprietary information is provided by an Applicant in a proposal, which constitutes a trade secret, commercial or financial information, it will be treated in confidence, to the extent permitted by law, provided that the proposal is clearly marked by the applicant.

IV. CERTIFICATIONS AND REGISTRATIONS

a. System for Award Management (SAM) Registration

Before the DOD can award a contract, applicant firms must be registered in the System for Award Management (SAM). SAM allows firms interested in conducting business with the federal government to provide basic information on business structure and capabilities as well as financial and payment information. To register, visit http://www.sam.gov. Firms should login to SAM and ensure the firm's registration is active and representations and certifications are up-to-date to avoid delay in award.

Registration in SAM will generate the Unique Entity ID (UEI) number and the Commercial and Government Entry (CAGE) code. The UEI is required for registration in the U.S. Small Business Administration's (SBA) Company Registry.

SAM.gov registration should reflect ALL AWARDS for Purpose of Registration. Firms registered to receive grants only will be ineligible.

b. SBA Company Registry

Proposing SBCs must be registered in the SBA Company Registry. SBCs will be required to verify registration by providing the SBC Control ID and Proof of Registration/Certification during proposal submission.

c. Defense SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) Registration

Individuals from proposing SBCs must be registered in the DSIP to prepare and submit proposals. Proposing SBCs submitting through this site for the first time will be asked to register. All users are required to have an individual user account to access DSIP. It is recommended proposing SBCs register as soon as possible upon identification of a proposal opportunity to avoid delays in the proposal submission process.

DSIP user accounts are authenticated by Login.gov. Users who do not already have a Login.gov account will be required to create one. Users who already have a Login.gov account can link their existing

Login.gov account with their DSIP account. Job Aids and Help Videos to walk you through the process are in the Learning & Support section of DSIP.

Be advised the sharing of accounts and passwords is a violation of the Terms of Use for Login.gov and DoD policy.

Registered SBCs will have a designated DSIP Firm Admin responsible for creating the Firm PIN, controlling access for other users in the SBC and completing and maintaining the Firm-level forms, which must be completed before any proposals can be submitted.

Users should complete their account registrations as soon as possible to avoid any delays in proposal submissions.

NOTE: The DSIP application is only accessible from within the United States, which is defined as the fifty states, the territories and possessions of the Federal Government, the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico, the Republic of the Marshall Islands, the Federated States of Micronesia, the Republic of Palau, and the District of Columbia.

Email DSIP Support at DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com **only** for assistance with using the DSIP application. Questions regarding DSIP can be emailed to DSIP Support and will be addressed in the order received, during normal operating hours (Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. ET). Please include information on your firm, a proposal number (if applicable), and screenshots of any pertinent errors or issues encountered.

DSIP Support cannot provide updates to proposal status after submission, such as proposal selection/non-selection status or contract award status. Do not attempt to directly submit proposal documents to the above email address. Such transmissions do not constitute proposal submission and such materials will be discarded.

d. Required Certifications

At the time of proposal submission, each SBC must certify via the Cover Sheet (Volume 1) of the proposal that it meets the size, ownership, and other requirements of the SBIR Program. In addition, the Policy Directive includes certification requirements set forth in the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Public Law 117-183). SBCs are required to certify that they are meeting the Program's requirements during the life cycle of the funding agreement: at the time of the Phase I and Phase II award, prior to final payment on the Phase I award, prior to receiving 50 percent of the total Phase II award amount, and prior to final payment on the Phase II award.

e. Due Diligence Program to Assess Security Risks

15 U.S.C. §638 (vv) requires the DoD, in coordination with the SBA, to establish and implement a due diligence program to assess and, when possible, mitigate national security risks from SBCs seeking a federally funded award. The Department will use the proposal and information in response to the "Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries" (proposal submission Volume 7) to conduct a risk-based due diligence review of the following areas: cybersecurity practices; patent analysis; employee analysis and foreign ownership, including the SBC's financial ties and obligations (which shall include surety, equity, and debt obligations); and SBC employees' ties to a foreign country, foreign person, or foreign entity. The Department will also assess proposals utilizing open-source analysis and analytical tools, for the purpose of confirming the accuracy of the information provided as well as determining if the proposing SBC failed to disclose the information set forth in 15 U.S.C. 638(g)(13).

After reviewing the proposing SBC's responses to the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries, if DoD determines it appropriate the Department may ask the SBC to provide true copies of any contractual or financial obligation or other agreement specific to a business arrangement or joint-venture like arrangement with an enterprise owned by a foreign state or any foreign entity in effect during the five-year period preceding the SBC's proposal submission.

The DoD may not make awards that pose an unacceptable risk to national security. If the risk-based due diligence review concludes that an SBC should not be eligible for the specific SBIR or STTR award due to a national security risk that cannot be adequately mitigated, the proposal will not receive consideration for possible award regardless of the results of the technical review of the proposal. Attachment 2: Defense SBIR and STTR Due Diligence Program Common Risk Matrix of the memo titled "Defense Small Business Innovation Research and Small Business Technology Transfer Due Diligence Program", dated 13 May 2024, provides details on the factors for assessing SBC risk during the due diligence review.

The DoD has partnered with Project Spectrum to provide an online course on Understanding Foreign Ownership, Control, or Influence (FOCI). This course defines FOCI, explains what it means to be under FOCI, and details FOCI's effect on a company seeking initial or continued eligibility for access to a federally funded award. Small business concerns can register and access this course by following the instructions below:

- Go to projectspectrum.io
- Click "Profile/Dashboard in the top right and then click "Sign Up" from the dropdown menu.
- Follow the instructions to sign up for an account. Descriptions of the account types are provided below each option.
- Verify your email by entering the code sent to the email address you provided when signing up.
- Log in to Project Spectrum by clicking "Profile/Dashboard > Login" in the top right.
- Find the Training Course on "Understanding Foreign Ownership, Control, or Influence (FOCI)" by clicking "Courses > Training Courses"
- Copy the provided password.
- Click on the course and log in to Encite.io using your email address and the copied password.
- Enroll in the course and click "Enter" to begin.

For assistance with registration or access to the Project Spectrum website, please contact support@projectspectrum.io.

f. Joint Ventures

Joint ventures and limited partnerships are eligible to submit proposals to this solicitation, provided that the entity created qualifies as a small business IAW the Small Business Act, 13 U.S.C. § 121.701. Proposing small business concerns must disclose joint ventures with existing (or planned) relationships/partnerships with any foreign entity or foreign government-controlled companies.

Joint venture applicants must submit the representations found here by uploading the representations to Volume 5, Supporting Documents.

g. Conflicts of Interest

Contract awards to an SBC owned by or employing current, or previous, Federal Government employees could create conflicts of interest for those employees, which may be a violation of federal law.

In accordance with FAR 9.5, proposing SBCs are required to identify and disclose all facts relevant to potential organizational conflicts of interest (OCIs) involving the proposing SBC's organization and any

proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant). The proposing SBC is responsible for providing this disclosure with each submitted proposal. The disclosure must include the proposing SBC's, and as applicable, proposed team member's OCI mitigation plan. The OCI mitigation plan must include a description of the actions the proposing SBC has taken, or intends to take, to prevent the existence of conflicting roles that might bias the proposing SBC's judgment, and to prevent the proposing SBC from having unfair competitive advantage. The OCI mitigation plan will specifically discuss the disclosed OCI in the context of each of the OCI limitations outlined in FAR 9.505-1 through FAR 9.505-4.

As part of the FAR 9.5 disclosure requirement, a proposing SBC must affirm whether the proposing SBC or any proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant) is providing SETA, A&AS, or similar support to any DoD Service/Component office(s) under: (a) a current award or sub-award; or (b) a past award or sub-award that ended within one calendar year prior to the proposal's submission date. If SETA, A&AS, or similar support is or was provided to any DoD Service/Component office(s), the proposal must include:

- The name of the DoD Service/Component office receiving the support;
- The prime contract number;
- Identification of proposed team member (sub-awardee, consultant) providing the support; and
- An OCI mitigation plan in accordance with FAR 9.5.

Government Procedures

In accordance with FAR 9.503, 9.504 and 9.506, the Government will evaluate OCI mitigation plans to avoid, neutralize, or mitigate potential OCI issues before award and determine whether it is in the government's interest to grant a waiver. The government may require proposing SBCs provide additional information to support evaluation of the proposing SBC's OCI mitigation plan. If the government determines a applicant failed to fully disclose an OCI; or failed to provide a government waiver as described above; or failed to reasonably provide additional information the government requested when evaluating the applicant's OCI mitigation plan, the government may reject the proposal and withdraw it from consideration for award.

h. Research Involving Human Subjects/Human Subject Research (RIHS/RHS)

All research involving human subjects, to include use of human biological specimens and human data, shall comply with the applicable federal and state laws, and agency policy/guidelines for human subject protection.

Institutions receiving funding for research involving human subjects must provide documentation of a current federal assurance of compliance with federal regulations for human subject protection; for example a Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Human Research Protections Federalwide assurance (http://www.hhs.gov/ohrp). The DOD may also request additional federal assurance documentation. All institutions engaged in human subject research, to include subcontractors, must also have a valid assurance. In addition, personnel involved in human subjects research must provide documentation of completed appropriate training for the protection of human subjects. Institutions proposing to conduct human subject research that meets one of the exemption criteria in 32 CFR 219.101 are not required to have a federal assurance of compliance. Proposing SBCs should clearly segregate research activities involving human subjects from other R&D activities in their proposal. If selected, institutions must also provide documentation of institutional review board (IRB) approval, or a determination from an appropriate official in the institution, that the work meets one of the exemption criteria with 32 CFR 219. As part of the IRB review process, evidence that all investigators are appropriately trained should accompany the protocol. The protocol, separate from the proposal, must include a detailed description of the research plan, study population, risks and benefits of study participation, recruitment and consent process, and data collection and analysis.

The amount of time required for the IRB to review and approve the protocol will vary based on the IRB's procedures, the complexity of the research, the level of risk to study participants and the responsiveness of the investigator. The average IRB approval process can last between one and three months. Once the IRB has approved the research, the awarding DOD will review the protocol and the IRB's determination to ensure that the research will be conducted in compliance with both DoD and DOD policies. The DOD review process can last between three to six months. Ample time should be allotted to complete both the IRB and DOD approval processes prior to recruiting subjects. No funding can be used towards human subject research until ALL approvals are granted. Submitters proposing research involving human and/or animal use are encouraged to separate these tasks in the technical proposal and cost proposal to avoid potential contract award delays.

i. Research Involving Recombinant DNA Molecules

All research involving recombinant DNA molecules shall comply with the applicable federal and state law, regulation, and additional agency guidance. An institutional biosafety committee must approve the research. In addition to the standard federal and DoD procurement certifications, the SBA SBIR Policy Directive requires that applicants provide certain information at time of award and during the award life cycle. Each proposing SBC must provide this additional information at the time of the Phase I and Phase II award, prior to final payment on the Phase I award, prior to receiving 50 percent of the Phase II total award amount, and prior to final payment on the Phase II award.

j. Use of Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS)

All activities involving the operation of Unmanned Aerial Systems shall be conducted IAW Department of Defense Memo entitled "Guidance for the Domestic Use of Unmanned Aircraft Systems in the U.S. National Airspace", dated 18 August 2018 and DOD memo entitled, "Delegation Authority to Approve Exemptions for Using Commercial-Off-The-Shelf Unmanned Aerial Systems in Support of Urgent Needs", dated 16 November 2018. Contractor personnel operating DoD or DoD- contracted UAS in U.S. National Airspace, whether or not the domestic use is related to an intelligence activity, will comply with all laws, regulations, and guidance relating to the operation of UAS in U.S. National Airspace. Specific programs utilizing UAS are required to obtain an exemption for operational use of a UAS; therefore, additional documentation may be requested by the awarding agency to support an exemption request. The DOD exemption approval process can require as long as two months. **No funding can be used for contracted-UAS operations until ALL approvals are granted.**

k. Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act Orders

FAR 52.204-29 Federal Acquisition Supply Chain Security Act (FASCA) Orders—Representation and Disclosures and FAR 52.204-30 FASCA Orders—Prohibition are included in this solicitation. In accordance with FAR 52.204-29 and FAR 52.204-30, proposing SBCs must review FASCSA orders here for covered articles, or any products or services produced or provided by a source, that an applicable FASCSA order prohibits.

During contract performance, the contractor shall review SAM.gov at least once every three months, or as the contracting officer advises, to check for covered articles, or products or services produced subject as part of any new FASCSA order(s) that could impact their supply chain, and report to the contracting officer any covered article, or product or service produced or provided by a source provided to the government or used during the contract performance.

The proposing SBC represents that, via proposal submission under this CSO, it conducted a reasonable inquiry, and it does not propose to provide or use any covered article, or any products or services produced or provided by a source, if an applicable FASCSA prohibited the covered article or the source effective this CSO's issue date.

V. MISCELLANEOUS INFORMATION

a. Award Information

Awards are executed as firm-fixed-price contracts or Other Transactions Authority (OTA) under 10 USC 4021 (Research Projects), 10 USC 4022 (Prototype), or 10 USC 4023 (Procurement for Experimental Purposes). Follow-on production OTs are possible as a result of OT awards made under this solicitation.

b. Fee or Profit

The DOD is required to provide reasonable fee or profit, consistent with normal profit margins provided to profit-making firms for R/R&D work. As such, the DOD reserves the right to reject any proposal that fails to account for reasonable profit or fee.

c. Payment Milestones

The frequency of payments under awards resulting from this CSO will be determined by the agreed-upon milestone schedules incorporated into the award document. Technical Milestone schedules are used as a means to monitor technical progress, to mitigate technical and cost risk, and to address the cashflow needs of awardees.

d. Contractual Requirements

Awardees will be required to make certain legal commitments through acceptance of Government contract clauses or OT articles. The following outline is illustrative of provisions required by the FAR or statute for inclusion in Phase II awards. This is not a complete list, nor does it contain specific clause/article wording.

i. Standards of Work

Work performed under the award must conform to professional standards.

ii. Inspection

Work performed under the award is subject to Government inspection and evaluation at all reasonable times.

iii. Examination of Records

The Comptroller General (or a fully authorized representative) shall have the right to examine any directly pertinent awardee records involving award transactions.

iv. Termination For Cause

The Government may terminate the award for failure to perform the negotiated effort.

v. Termination for Convenience

The Government may terminate the award at any time if it deems termination in its best interest. The firm will be compensated for work performed and reasonable termination costs.

vi. Disputes

Any award dispute not resolved by agreement shall be decided by the Contracting or Agreements Officer with right of appeal.

vii. Contract/OT Work Hours

The awardee may not require an employee to work more than eight hours a day or forty hours a week unless compensated accordingly through overtime pay.

viii. Equal Opportunity

The firm will not discriminate against any employee or employee applicant because of race, color, religion, sex, or national origin.

ix. Affirmative Action for Veterans

The awardee will not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because he or she is a disabled veteran.

x. Affirmative Action for Handicapped Individuals

The awardee will not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because he or she is physically or mentally handicapped.

xi. Officials Not to Benefit

No Federal Government official may benefit personally from the SBIR/STTR funding agreement.

xii. Covenant Against Contingent Fees

No person or agency has been employed to solicit or secure the award upon an understanding for compensation except bona fide employees or commercial agencies maintained by the awardee for the purpose of securing business.

xiii. Gratuities

The Government may terminate the award if gratuities have been offered to any Government representative to secure the award.

xiv. Patent Infringement

The awardee shall report each notice or patent infringement claim based on contract performance.

xv. Military Security Requirements

The awardee shall safeguard classified information associated with the contracted work IAW applicable regulations.

xvi. American-Made Equipment and Products

The awardee will purchase equipment and/or products in support of the SBIR award from U.S.-based sources whenever possible.

xvii. Unique Identification (UID)

If hardware will be delivered to the Government under the award, there is potential unique item identification will be required IAW DFARS 252.211-7003 or similar verbiage.

xviii. Publication Approval/Disclosure of Information

Government review and approval will be required prior to dissemination or publication, except within and between the awardee and its subcontractors (if any), of classified and non- fundamental information developed under this award or contained in reports to be furnished pursuant to this award.

xix. Animal Welfare

Awards involving research, development, test, evaluation, or training on vertebrate animals will incorporate DFARS clause 252.235-7002 or similar verbiage.

xx. Protection of Human Subjects

Effective 29 July 2009, awards including or potentially including research involving human subjects IAW 32 CFR Part 219, DoD Directive 3216.02, and 10 U.S.C. 980, including research meeting exemption criteria under 32 CFR 219.101(b), will incorporate DFARS clause 252.235-7004 or similar verbiage.

All research involving human subjects, to include use of human biological specimens and human data, shall comply with the applicable federal and state laws and DoD policy/guidelines for human subject protection.

Institutions to be awarded funding for research involving human subjects (RIHS) must provide documentation of a current Federal Assurance of Compliance with Federal regulations for human subject protection, for example a Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Human Research Protections Federalwide Assurance (http://www.hhs.gov/ohrp). Additional Federal Assurance documentation may also be requested by the DOD. All institutions engaged in human subject research, to include subcontractor, must also have a valid Assurance. In additional, personnel involved in human subject research must provide documentation of completing appropriate training for the protection of human subjects.

As a condition of award, institutions must also provide documentation of Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval or a determination from an appropriate official in the institution that the work meets one of the exemption criteria in 32 C.F.R. 219. As part of the IRB review process, evidence of appropriate training for all investigators will need to be provided.

xxi. E-Verify

Contracts exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold may include the FAR clause 52.222- 54 "Employment Eligibility Verification" unless exempted by the conditions listed at FAR 22.1803.

i. Similar verbiage will be included in OT awards unless determined exempt through comparable determination.

xxii. Cybersecurity

Awardees are required to provide adequate security on all covered business information systems. Specific security requirements are listed in DFARS 252.204.7012, and compliance is mandatory. Note, DFARS clauses 252.204-7019 and 252.204-7020 also apply to this solicitation.

xxiii. Safeguarding Covered Defense Information Control

As prescribed in DFARS 252.204- 7008, for covered contractor information systems that are not part of an information technology service or system operated on behalf of the Government, the SBC represents that it will implement the security requirements specified by National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-171, "Protecting Controlled Unclassified Information in Nonfederal Information Systems and Organizations".

xxiv. Limitations on the Use or Disclosure of Third- Party Contractor Reported Cyber Incident Information

As required in DFARS 252.204-7009, the Contractor must agree that certain conditions apply to any information it receives or creates in the performance of a resulting contract that is information obtained from a third-party's reporting of a cyber incident pursuant to DFARS clause 252.204-7012, Safeguarding Covered Defense Information and Cyber Incident Reporting (or derived from such information obtained under that clause).

xxv. Basic Safeguarding of Covered Contractor Information Systems

FAR 52.204-21, Basic Safeguarding of Covered Contractor Information Systems, is incorporated into this solicitation. In accordance with FAR 52.204-21, the contractor shall apply basic safeguarding requirements and procedures when the contractor or a subcontractor at any tier may have Federal contract information residing in or transiting through its information system.

xxvi. Prohibition on Contracting with Persons Who Have Business Operations with the Maduro Regime

DFARS 252.225-7055, Representation Regarding Business Operations with the Maduro Regime, is incorporated into this solicitation. In accordance with section 890 of the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2020 (Pub. L. 116-92), DoD is prohibited from entering into a contract for the procurement of products or services with any person that has business operations with an authority of the government of Venezuela that is not recognized as the legitimate government of Venezuela by the United States Government, unless the person has a valid license to operate in Venezuela issued by the Office of Foreign Assets Control of the Department of the Treasury.

xxvii. Prohibition on a ByteDance Covered Application

FAR 52.204-27, Prohibition on a ByteDance Covered Application, is incorporated into this solicitation. In accordance with FAR 52.204-27, contractors are prohibited from having or using a covered application on any information technology owned or managed by the Government, or on any information technology used or provided by contractors under contracts, including on equipment provided by the Contractor's employees.

e. Agency Recovery and Ongoing Reporting

In accordance with Section 5 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022, the DOD will-

1) Require a small business concern receiving an award under its SBIR program to repay all amounts received from the DOD under the award if—
   - the small business concern makes a material misstatement that the DOD determines poses a risk to national security; or

- there is a change in ownership, change to entity structure, or other substantial change in circumstances of the small business concern that the Federal DOD determines poses a risk to national security; and

2) Require a small business concern receiving an award under its SBIR program to regularly report to the DOD and the Administration throughout the duration of the award on
    - any change to a disclosure required under the subparagraphs above;
    - any material misstatement made under the subparagraphs above; and
    - any change described above

f. Copyrights

With prior written permission of the contracting officer, the awardee may copyright (consistent with any appropriate national security considerations) material developed with DoD support. DoD receives a royalty-free license for the Federal Government and requires that each publication contain an appropriate acknowledgment and disclaimer statement.

g. Patents

Awardees normally may retain the principal worldwide patent rights to any invention developed with U.S. Government support. The government receives a royalty-free license for its use, reserves the right to require the patent holder to license others in certain limited circumstances, and requires that anyone exclusively licensed to sell the invention in the United States must normally manufacture it domestically. 35 U.S.C. § 205 authorizes that the government will not make public any information disclosing a government-supported invention for a period of five years to allow the awardee to pursue a patent. See also Section 6.8, Invention Reporting.

h. Invention Reporting

SBIR awardees must report inventions to the DOD within two months of the inventor's report to the awardee, via either paper documentation submission, including fax, or through the Edison Invention Reporting System at www.iedison.gov.

i. Technical Data Rights

Rights in technical data, including software, developed under the terms of any award resulting from proposals submitted in response to this CSO generally remain with the contractor, except that the U.S. Government obtains a royalty-free license to use such technical data only for government purposes during the period commencing with contract award and ending not less than twenty years after that date. This data should be marked with the restrictive legend specified in DFARS 252.227-7018.

Upon expiration of the twenty-year restrictive license, the government has government purpose rights in the SBIR data. During the license period, the U.S. Government may not release or disclose SBIR data to any person other than its support services contractors except: (1) for evaluation purposes; (2) as expressly permitted by the contractor; or (3) a use, release, or disclosure that is necessary for emergency repair or overhaul government-operated items. See DFARS clause 252.227-7018.

j. Multiple Procurements Planned

The CSO is seeking varying technical/scientific approaches and/or varying and new technologies that would be responsive to the problem statement(s) and area(s) of interest in the topic. Multiple procurements are planned and anticipated to be awarded as a result of the topic. Each proposal is considered a separate procurement and will be evaluated on its own merit. The DoD may award all of the proposals, some of the proposals, or none of the proposals submitted. Any per-award or per-topic funding caps are budgetary estimates only, and more or less funding may become available. Funding decisions are made with complete disregard to the other awards under the same topic.

k. Treatment of Proposals Received

The DOD reserves the right to award all of the proposals, some of the proposals, or none of the proposals submitted. The Federal Government is not responsible for any monies expended by the applicant before award. The SBIR/STTR Programs are not substitutes for existing unsolicited proposal mechanisms. Unsolicited proposals are not accepted under the DoD SBIR/STTR Programs for Phases I or II.

l. CSO, Selection, and Award Protests

Interested parties have the right to protest via procedures in FAR Subpart 33.1; protests exclusively related to this CSO's terms must be served to: osd.ncr.ousd-r-e.mbx.SBIR-STTR-Protest@mail.mil.

For protests filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), a copy of the protest shall be submitted to the email address listed above (pre-award ONLY) or DoD Service/Component POC (postselection/award decision ONLY) within one day of filing with the GAO. Protests of small business status of a selected proposing SBC may also be made to the SBA via the procedures in FAR § 19.302.

For the purposes of a protest related to a particular topic selection, non-selection or award decision, protests should be served to the point-of-contact (POC) listed in the instructions of the DoD Component that authored the topic.

m. Technical Questions Related to Prospective Applicant Proposed Technical Solution

Applicants may submit written questions through DSIP Topic Q&A at https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/submissions/login. In Topic Q&A, all questions and answers are posted electronically for general viewing. Identifying information for the questioner and respondent is not posted.

Questions submitted through the Topic Q&A are limited to technical information related to improving the understanding of a topic's requirements. **Any other questions, such as those asking for advice or guidance on solution approach, or administrative questions, such as SBIR or STTR program eligibility, technical proposal/cost proposal structure and page count, budget and duration limitations, or proposal due date WILL NOT receive a response.** As indicated above, applicants have ample opportunities to seek clarification regarding solicitation terms and provisions prior to the solicitation closing.

VI. APPENDIX A: DEFINITIONS

Note, additional definitions applicable to the SBIR/STTR program are available in the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive located at https://www.sbir.gov/sites/default/files/SBA%20SBIR_STTR_POLICY_DIRECTIVE_May2023.pdf.

Commercialization

The process of developing products, processes, technologies, or services and the production and delivery (whether by the originating party or others) of the products, processes, technologies, or services for sale to or use by the Federal government or commercial markets.

Essentially Equivalent Work

Work that is substantially the same research, which is proposed for funding in more than one contract proposal or grant application submitted to the same Federal agency or submitted to two or more different Federal agencies for review and funding consideration; or work where a specific research objective and the research design for accomplishing the objective are the same or closely related to another proposal or award, regardless of the funding source.

Export Control
The International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR), 22 CFR Parts 120 through 130, and the Export Administration Regulations (EAR), 15 CFR Parts 730 through 799, will apply to all projects with military or dual-use applications that develop beyond fundamental research, which is basic and applied research ordinarily published and shared broadly within the scientific community. More information is available at https://www.pmddtc.state.gov/ddtc_public.

NOTE: Export control compliance statements found in this document are not meant to be all inclusive. **They do not remove any liability from the applicant to comply with applicable ITAR or EAR export control restrictions** or from informing the Government of any potential export restrictions as fundamental research and development efforts proceed.

Foreign Persons
A foreign person is any natural person who is not a “lawful permanent resident” as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1101(a)(20) or who is not a "protected individual” as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1324b(a)(3). It also means any foreign corporation, business association, partnership, trust, society, or any other entity or group that is not incorporated or organized to do business in the United States, as well as international organizations, foreign governments, and any agency or subdivision of foreign governments (e.g., diplomatic missions).

“Lawfully admitted for permanent residence” (or someone who is a “lawful permanent resident”) means the status of having been lawfully accorded the privilege of residing permanently in the United States as an immigrant in accordance with the immigration laws, such status not having changed.

"Protected individual’’ means an individual who (A) is a citizen or national of the United States, or (B) is an alien who is lawfully admitted for permanent residence, is granted the status of an alien lawfully admitted for temporary residence under 8 U.S.C. § 1160(a) or 8 U.S.C. § 1255a(a)(1), is admitted as a refugee under 8 U.S.C. § 1157, or is granted asylum under Section 8 U.S.C. § 1158; but does not include

(i) an alien who fails to apply for naturalization within six months of the date the alien first becomes eligible (by virtue of period of lawful permanent residence) to apply for naturalization or, if later, within six months after November 6, 1986, and
(ii) an alien who has applied on a timely basis, but has not been naturalized as a citizen within 2 years after the date of the application, unless the alien can establish that the alien is actively pursuing naturalization, except that time consumed in the Service's processing the application shall not be counted toward the 2-year period.

Funding Agreement
Any contract, grant, or cooperative agreement entered into between any Federal Agency and any small business concern for the performance of experimental, developmental, or research work, including products or services, funded in whole or in part by the Federal Government. Only contracts and other transaction authority (OTA) agreements will be used by the DOD for SBIR awards. Additionally, all awards made under this CSO will be Firm-Fixed-Price.

Research or Research and Development (R/R&D)
Any activity that is:
a. A systematic, intensive study directed toward greater knowledge or understanding of the subject studied.
b. A systematic study directed specifically toward applying new knowledge to meet a recognized need; or

c. A systematic application of knowledge toward the production of useful materials, devices, and systems or methods, including design, development, and improvement of prototypes and new processes to meet specific requirements.

Small Business Concern (SBC)
A concern that meets the requirements set forth in 13 C.F.R. § 121.702 (available here: https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-13/chapter-I/part-121/subpart-A/subject-group-ECFRb7921b3fcf04228/section-121.702).
An SBC must satisfy the following conditions on the date of award:

a. Is organized for profit, with a place of business located in the United States, which operates primarily within the United States or which makes a significant contribution to the United States economy through payment of taxes or use of American products, materials or labor;
b. Is in the legal form of an individual proprietorship, partnership, limited liability company, corporation, joint venture, association, trust or cooperative, except that if the concern is a joint venture, each entity to the venture must meet the requirements set forth in paragraph (c) below;
c. Is more than 50% directly owned and controlled by one or more individuals (who are citizens or permanent resident aliens of the United States), other small business concerns (each of which is more than 50% directly owned and controlled by individuals who are citizens or permanent resident aliens of the United States), or any combination of these; and
d. Has, including its affiliates, not more than 500 employees. (For explanation of affiliate, see www.sba.gov/size.)

Version 2

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE (DAF)
SMALL BUSINESS INNOVATION RESEARCH (SBIR)
COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING (CSO)

X25.5 RELEASE 10
SBIR PHASE I
TOPIC RELEASE INSTRUCTIONS (TRI)

July 2, 2025: Topics Open; DoD begins accepting proposals in DSIP
July 15, 2025: Deadline for submission of questions to DAF, at 4:00 p.m. ET
(refer to section II.b below for details on submitting questions)
August 5, 2025: Topics Close; Deadline for receipt of proposals is 12:00 p.m. ET

TABLE OF CONTENTS

I. DoD X25 COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING (CSO) 4
II. DAF X25.5 RELEASE 10 PHASE I TOPIC RELEASE INSTRUCTIONS (TRI) 4
a. GENERAL TOPIC INFORMATION 4
i. Solicitation Topics Information 4
ii. Due Date 5
iii. Number of Awards 5
iv. Maximum SBIR Funding Amount 5
v. Maximum Period of Performance 5
b. QUESTIONS ABOUT THIS TOPIC RELEASE AND TOPIC RELEASE INSTRUCTIONS 5
i. Questions and Answers Open Periods 5
ii. Solicitation Terms and Conditions Questions 5
iii. Administrative Questions 6
iv. DSIP Related Questions 6
c. SELECTION METHODOLOGY AND EVALUATION CRITERIA 6
i. Defense Need 6
ii. Technical Approach 6
iii. Commercialization 7
d. COVER SHEET (VOLUME 1) 8
e. TECHNICAL VOLUME (VOLUME 2) 8
Table 1: Technical Volume Content Description (Volume 2) 8
f. COST VOLUME (VOLUME 3) 13
Table 2: Cost Volume Description (Volume 3) 13
g. COMPANY COMMERCIALIZATION REPORT (VOLUME 4) 14
h. SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS (VOLUME 5) 14
Table 3: Supporting Documents (Volume 5) 14
i. FRAUD, WASTE, AND ABUSE (FWA) TRAINING (VOLUME 6) 18
j. DISCLOSURES OF FOREIGN AFFILIATIONS OR RELATIONSHIPS TO FOREIGN COUNTRIES (VOLUME 7) 18
k. MISCELLANEOUS 18
i. Common Disqualifiers 18
ii. DAF SBIR/STTR Open Topic Objectives 18
iii. Proposal Review Information 18
iv. Proposal Status and Feedback 19
v. Use of Support Contractors for the DAF SBIR Program 19

l. AFX255-PCSO1 TITLE: Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear Air Force Stakeholder Need 20

OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas: 20

Objectives: 20

Description: 20

Phase I: 21

Phase II: 21

Phase III Dual-Use Applications: 21

References: 21

Key Words: 21

m. AFX255-PCSO2 TITLE: Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear Space Force Stakeholder Need 22

OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas: 22

USSF Commercial Space Strategy Mission Areas: 22

Objectives: 22

Description: 22

Phase I: 23

Phase II: 23

Phase III Dual-Use Applications: 24

References: 24

Keywords: 24

n. ATTACHMENTS 25

Version 2

I. DoD X25 COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING (CSO)

See the Department of Defense (DoD) X25.5 Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) for SBIR information specific to the Open Topic program and applicable laws, policies, and regulations.

The Department of the Air Force (DAF) intends these proposal submission instructions to clarify the DoD X25.5 CSO as it applies to the topics solicited herein. **Firms must ensure proposals meet all requirements of the SBIR Program CSO posted on the DoD SBIR/STTR Innovation Portal (DSIP) at the proposal submission deadline date/time.**

II. DAF X25.5 RELEASE 10 PHASE I TOPIC RELEASE INSTRUCTIONS (TRI)

Release Number	Topic Number	Topic Title	Anticipated Number of Awards	Release Dates, Funding, Period of Performance	Agency POCs
X25.5 Release 10	AFX255-PCSO1	Open Topic Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear **Air Force** Stakeholder Need	260	**Open:** July 2, 2025 **Close:** August 5, 2025, at 12:00pm Noon ET Maximum SBIR Funding Amount: $75,000 Maximum Period of Performance: 90 calendar days	Air Force SBIR/STTR Contracting Officer Daniel Brewer (daniel.brewer.13@us.af.mil) and solicitations@afwerx.af.mil
	AFX255-PCSO2	Open Topic Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear **Space Force** Stakeholder Need			

a. GENERAL TOPIC INFORMATION

i. Solicitation Topics Information

There are two (2) topics covered within this TRI. Open Topic AFX255-PCSO1 is specific to Air Force stakeholder needs, and Open Topic AFX255-PCSO2 is specific to Space Force stakeholder needs.

This release contains an open topic. As outlined in section 7 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022, innovation open topic activities—

A. Increase the transition of commercial technology to the Department of Defense;
B. Expand the small business nontraditional industrial base;
C. Increase commercialization derived from investments of the Department of Defense; and
D. Expand the ability for qualifying small business concerns to propose technology solutions to meet the needs of the Department of Defense.

Unlike conventional topics, which specify the desired technical objective and output, open topics can use generalized mission requirements or specific technology areas to adapt commercial products or solutions

to close capability gaps, improve performance, or provide technological advancements in existing capabilities.

A Small Business Concern (SBC) may only submit one (1) proposal under this topic release. An applicant may apply to one (1), but not to both, of the topics contained in this topic release. If more than one proposal from an applicant is received for either or both open topics contained in this topic release, only the most recent proposal to be certified and submitted prior to the submission deadline will receive an evaluation. All prior proposals will be marked as non-responsive and will not receive an evaluation.

ii. Due Date

The DAF will begin accepting proposals on July 2, 2025. **All proposals must be submitted by August 5, 2025, at 12:00 p.m. (noon) ET**. No exceptions will be made to the above submission deadlines. Proposals submitted after this date and time will not be considered for award.

iii. Number of Awards

The DAF currently anticipates making **260** open topic awards under this topic release. Any per-award or per-topic funding caps are budgetary estimates only, and more or less funding may become available. The TRI is seeking varying technical/scientific approaches and/or varying and new technologies that would be responsive to the problem statement(s) and area(s) of interest in the topic. Multiple procurements are planned and anticipated to be awarded as a result of the topic, each proposal is considered a separate procurement and will be evaluated on its own merit, and that the Government may award all, some, or none of the proposals. Funding decisions are made with complete disregard to the other awards under the same topic.

iv. Maximum SBIR Funding Amount

Proposals that exceed **$75,000.00** in value will not be considered for award. This amount does not include validated matching non-SBIR/STTR funding, either through private matching funds or non-SBIR/STTR governmental funding secured from a non-AFWERX entity.

v. Maximum Period of Performance

Proposals that exceed **90 calendar days** in duration will not be considered for award. Note: this is the TOTAL duration of the award. The DAF will not make distinctions between “technical” and “reporting” periods.

b. QUESTIONS ABOUT THIS TOPIC RELEASE AND TOPIC RELEASE INSTRUCTIONS

i. Questions and Answers Open Periods

There are dedicated periods for submitting questions related to the solicitation (CSO/TRI) and questions related to DSIP application submission.

The subject line of all submitted questions must identify the TRI to which you are inquiring.

ii. Solicitation Terms and Conditions Questions

Focus: Applicants may request clarification on the terms, conditions, and/or requirements of the solicitation, including all solicitation attachments.
Open Period: July 2, 2025 - July 15, 2025, 4:00pm Eastern Time.
Submission Instructions: Questions shall be emailed to Daniel.Brewer.13@us.af.mil and solicitations@afwerx.af.mil. Ensure both email addresses are included on the recipient list.

Responses: DAF intends to release a consolidated list of received questions and their respective answers on approximately July 18, 2025. DAF reserves the right not to answer every question submitted and will not answer any questions asking for feedback on the content of a specific applicant's proposal. All submitted questions will be kept anonymous.

All questions must be submitted by the deadline provided in the applicable Open Period (Solicitation Terms and Conditions, Administrative, and DSIP Related) in order to be considered. Questions received after each respective Open Period deadline will be deemed late and may not receive a response.

iii. Administrative Questions

Focus: Administrative questions based on the process, not the interpretation of solicitation terms and conditions
Open Period: Solicitation open period
Questions shall be emailed to: Daniel.Brewer.13@us.af.mil, and solicitations@afwerx.af.mil. Ensure both email addresses are included on the recipient list.
Responses: Applicants will receive direct email responses. The Air Force will not answer questions that pertain solely to the DSIP application.

iv. DSIP Related Questions

Focus: Issues related to DSIP website navigation and proposal submission processes solely as they relate to the DSIP application.
Open Period: July 2, 2025 through solicitation closing date/time
Email questions to: DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com
Responses: DSIP helpdesk will respond directly to applicant questions.

c. SELECTION METHODOLOGY AND EVALUATION CRITERIA

All Phase I proposals will be evaluated on a competitive basis. Proposals will be initially screened to determine responsiveness. Proposals will be peer reviewed based on the criteria below. Each proposal will be evaluated on its own merits. Evaluators will base their conclusions only on information contained in the proposal. It cannot be assumed that evaluators are acquainted with the small business concern or key individuals or any referenced experiments. Selections will represent the best value to the Government.

The following three (3) non-cost/price factors will be considered in descending order of importance:

i. Defense Need

The Defense Need being fulfilled and ability of the proposal to impact that Defense Need

a. The appropriateness, relevance, and specificity of an identified Defense Need.
b. Adequacy of the proposed effort and its relationship to fulfilling the identified Defense Need.
c. The applicant's understanding of the proposed Defense Need and the proposed technology's logical fit into the Defense Need identified.
d. The level of defense mission impact and urgency of the Defense Need.
e. The breadth of applicability of the solution.

ii. Technical Approach

a. The clarity of the problem statement, technical approach, soundness, technical merit, and innovation of the proposed technical approach.
b. The differentiation from current customer alternatives.

c. Includes the proposed Principal Investigator's/Project Manager's, supporting staff, and consultants' qualifications to execute the proposed approach.

iii. Commercialization

The potential for government or private sector commercialization and benefits expected to accrue from commercialization.

a. The Small Business Concern's (SBC) record of commercializing SBIR or other research, as indicated by pre-sales, pilots, sales, revenue, active users, subscriptions, downloads, and/or other forms of traction/adoption.
b. The size of the market and potential for revenue.
c. The clarity of the SBC's business plan.
d. The existence of Phase II and/or Phase III follow-on commitments for the subject research and funding commitments related to the subject effort or private sources may be evidence of commercialization potential.

All evaluation criteria, other than cost or price, when combined, are significantly more important than cost or price. Where technical evaluations are essentially equal in merit, cost and/or price will be considered in determining successful applicants.

The DAF will accept proposals from Small Business Concerns (SBCs) that are owned in majority by multiple venture capital operating companies, hedge funds, or private equity firms in response to this solicitation. In accordance with 15 United States Code (U.S.C) 638(dd), the DAF is prohibited from awarding more than 15% of its SBIR budget to SBCs with the previously mentioned ownership structures. In addition to the criteria above, once the value of selected proposals from such SBCs reaches 15% of the DAF's SBIR budget, proposals from such SBCs will no longer be considered for award.

Price reasonableness and realism will be considered to the extent appropriate. IAW 15 USC 638(dd)(7), investment by venture capital, private equity firms, or hedge funds shall not be used as an award criterion.

Other Factors Considered During the Selection Process

The SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 (Pub. L. 117-183) requires the Department of Defense, in coordination with the Small Business Administration, to establish and implement a due diligence program to assess security risks presented by small business concerns seeking a federally funded award. The full text of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022 is available at https://www.congress.gov/117/plaws/publ183/PLAW-117publ183.pdf.

In accordance with 15 USC 638(vv) (Section 4 of the SBIR and STTR Extension Act of 2022); the Deputy Secretary of Defense Memorandum; Subject: Defense Small Business Innovation Research and Small Business Technology Transfer Due Diligence Program dated May 13th, 2024; and the Department of the Air Force Guidance Memorandum to AFI 61-102, on DAF Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) and Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) Due Diligence Program dated February 25, 2025, the Department of Defense will review all proposals submitted in response to this CSO to assess security risks presented by small business concerns seeking a Federally funded award. The Department will use information provided by the small business concern in in response to the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries and the proposal to conduct a risk-based due diligence review on the cybersecurity practices, patent analysis, employee analysis, and foreign ownership of a small business concern, including the financial ties and obligations (which shall include surety, equity,

and debt obligations) of the small business concern and employees of the small business concern to a foreign country, foreign person, or foreign entity. The Department will also assess proposals utilizing open-source analysis and analytical tools, for the nondisclosures of the information set forth in 15 U.S.C. 638(g)(13). If DoD assesses that a small business concern has security risk(s), DoD will review the proposal, the evaluation, and the security risks and may choose to either 1) create a plan to mitigate the risk(s) or 2) DoD may decide to not select the proposal for award based upon a totality of the review.

The DAF will also utilize a due diligence process as outlined in 15 U.S.C. 638(vv) to assess proposals utilizing open-source analysis and analytical tools. If DAF assesses that a small business concern has security risk(s), DoD will review the proposal, the evaluation, and the security risks and may choose not to select the proposal for award based upon a review of the totality of the circumstances. Additional information on due diligence can be found at https://media.defense.gov/2024/May/23/2003471996/-1/-1/1/DUE_DILIGENCE_PROGRAM_OSD003584_24_RES.PDF.

d. COVER SHEET (VOLUME 1)

The Cover Sheet (Volume 1) is prepared on DSIP and in accordance with the DoD Program CSO.

e. TECHNICAL VOLUME (VOLUME 2)

Table 1: Technical Volume Content Description (Volume 2)	
The proposal must provide sufficient information to demonstrate to the reviewers that the proposed work represents an innovative approach to investigation of important scientific or engineering problems and is worthy of support under the stated criteria. The proposed R/R&D must be responsive to the chosen topic.	
Item	**Description**
Format	The Technical Volume must be a single Portable Document Format (.pdf) file, including graphics. Perform a virus check before uploading the completed Proposal Template file. If a virus is detected, it may cause rejection of the proposal. Do not lock or encrypt the uploaded file. Use of the mandatory Phase I Proposal Template (Attachment 1) for Volume 2 (Technical Volume) is strictly required. Proposal Volume 2 **Volume 2 submissions that do not adhere to this template will be deemed non-responsive and disqualified. The correct proposal template for this solicitation is labeled "*25.5 Release 10 - SBIR/STTR Phase I Proposal Template*" at the top of the proposal template. It is the only acceptable version for this solicitation.** The submission of Volume 2 must strictly adhere to the provided mandatory template. Non-compliance with this requirement shall render the submission non-responsive. Do not include or embed active graphics such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media in the document. Do not include hyperlinks or any form of active link. Information linked to the proposal in such a manner will not be considered as part of the Government's evaluation. Font must be kept no smaller than 10-pt with at least ½-inch margins. Serif font is recommended for legibility.

	Each page should include the company name, topic number, and DSIP assigned proposal number. If your platform allows, this can be added as a footer. If your platform does not have the ability to add a footer, the required information can be added to the bottom of each page. **Please note that files submitted as part of Volume 2 have a file size limit of 15 MB.**
Content Layout/Table of Contents	The required proposal template designates content for each page. Content shall be bound to the designated page(s) indicated on the Proposal Template's Table of Contents. Only information on the designated, corresponding page(s) will be evaluated.
Proprietary Information in Proposal	If proprietary information is provided by an Applicant in a proposal, which constitutes a trade secret, commercial or financial information, it will be treated in confidence, to the extent permitted by law. Should an applicant's Volume 2 submission contain any proprietary information, the applicant shall do the following: (1) Place the following legend in the Proposal Template Table of Contents: This proposal contains information that shall not be disclosed outside the federal government and shall not be duplicated, used, or disclosed in whole or in part for any purpose other than evaluation of this proposal, unless authorized by law . The Government shall have the right to duplicate, use, or disclose the data to the extent provided in the resulting contract if award is made as a result of the submission of this proposal. The information subject to these restrictions are contained on all pages of the proposal except for pages [insert page numbers or other identification of pages that contain no restricted information]. AND (2) Mark each applicable page from Volume 2 that contains proprietary information with the following legend: Use or disclosure of information contained on this sheet is subject to the restriction on the table of contents page for Volume 2. This legend may be included within the footer of any applicable pages, except as otherwise annotated, of the Proposal Template document.
Technical Summary	

Version 2

Proposal Summary	Include Company Name and Overview of Proposal.
Technical Merit Summary including Key Personnel	Clearly communicate the scientific merit of the solution's central and/or enabling technological concepts, including the most effective points that demonstrate the technical merit of the solution. Identify the current scientific and/or technical baseline, referencing relevant scientific and technical literature, and describe the RDT&E effort's advancement of this baseline. Identify key personnel involved in the project, including subcontractors and consultants. The applicant shall address qualifications for conducting RDT&E in addition to qualifications for commercialization. Include information regarding education, experience, and citizenship. A technical resume for the PI, including publications, if any, shall be included.
Concept and Significance of Problem/Opportunity	Define the specific technical problem and/or opportunity addressed and its importance to your prospective customers. Describe how your proposed solution is better than the currently available alternatives in the commercial and defense markets. Quantify your proposed solution's benefits as much as possible. Communicate if and how the private sector variant of the proposed solution is different from the DoD-variant. Work proposed to the SBIR/STTR program MUST be R/R&D. Non-RDT&E procurement of commercially-available solutions is not appropriate for the SBIR/STTR program.
Defense Need	Demonstrate knowledge of prospective end-user(s)/customer(s) and their most reasonable use-case for your solution. Explore differentiation from current customer alternatives, and incremental progress toward fulfilling the identified defense need. Highlight previous DoD funding for the solution or underlying technology. Include a description of the proposed solution and how it compares to the user's current alternative. Explain the breadth of applicability for the proposed solution.
Transition Plan	Describe your plan to transition your solution into the DAF. Briefly describe how your proposed solution could integrate with the existing efforts of your proposed DAF customer.
Summary of the Proposed Solution's Commercialization and Non-Defense Commercial Potential Business Plan	Effectively demonstrate the firm's ability to commercialize the proposed solutions in both DoD and commercial markets. Describe the non-defense commercial solution, including its use by non-defense commercial customers, as well as the qualitative and quantitative value it brings to the proposed solution's users. Relevant supporting data, such as journal articles, literature, government publications, etc., should be contained or referenced in the proposal. 1. Include any applicable pilots, revenue, users, and/or other types of interest or resource investment to date that demonstrate the presence of viable customer markets and government/commercial investment for the proposed solution. Include if the proposed solution has been (i) sold, leased, or licensed to the public; OR (ii) offered for sale, lease, or license to the public. Provide quantifiable data evidencing this sale, lease, or licensing.

	2. Describe the proposed solution's competitive landscape and potential to scale the proposed solution. Include anticipated market segment (new or existing) and the potential percentage of market share the proposed solution could occupy. 3. Does the proposed solution represent an entirely novel standalone solution, or does it modify/build upon an existing product or service? Items to include: a. Is the proposed item "of a type", i.e., similar to a commercial item, customarily used by the public or by non-governmental entities for non-governmental purposes? b. How is the proposed solution different from similar competitor solutions? c. What are the end-user use cases for the proposed solution and how does the proposed solution fulfill these use cases? d. What is the non-defense market opportunity of your proposed solution? Can this be quantified or described? 4. What are the proposed solution's technical risks? 5. Broad adoption and commercial success can be indicators of commercial potential and reduced technical risk but are not mandated. Clearly delineate between the proposed solution's commercial success and the company's overall success. This is an RDT&E solicitation, not a Commercial-Off-the-Shelf (COTS) resale solicitation. See FAR 2.101 for a full definition of commercial items.
Related Work (Dual-Use)	Describe significant activities directly related to the proposed effort, including any conducted by the PI, proposing firm, consultants, or others. Describe how these activities interface with the proposed project and discuss planned coordination with outside sources. The technical volume must persuade reviewers of the proposer's awareness of the state-of-the-art in the specific topic. Describe similar previous and parallel work not directly related to the proposed effort. Provide the following: (1) Short description (2) Client POC name and phone number (3) Description of defense or commercial customers and interviews with them, if applicable (4) Completion date As RDT&E programs, SBIR/STTR efforts are subject to scientific and technical literature searches in order to establish technical baseline, avoid duplication, and justify funding IAW AFI 61-201, Management of Scientific and Technical Information (STINFO) (29 January 2019) and AFRL/CA guidance, Streamlined and Waivered SBIR/STTR Specified Requirements (05 Aug 2019).

Non-Proprietary Work Plan Outline (including subcontractors' efforts) and Phase I Objectives	Provide a clear description of the approach. Indicate what tasks are planned, how and where the work will be conducted, a schedule of major events and the final product(s) to be delivered. The Phase I effort should attempt to determine the technical feasibility of the proposed concept. Include an outline of the work plan in the following format: (a.) Scope: List the major objectives and specifications of the effort. (b.) Task Outline: Provide a brief outline of the work to be accomplished over the span of the effort. (c.) Deliverables (preliminary and final report) (d.) Deliverable Success Markers / Objectives: Describe how success will be measured in helping the prospective users (e.) Kickoff meeting within 30 calendar days of contract start (f.) Preliminary report (g.) Final report with SF 298 and DD Form 882 Although rare in a Phase I, any proposal that implicates **Human Subjects Research (HSR)** must specifically indicate which tasks fit the definition of HSR. Please refer to the DoD Program CSO for additional information on HSR.
Foreign Persons	Identify all foreign persons **and** non-U.S. citizens **and** dual citizens proposed as direct employees, subcontractors, or consultants. For these individuals, in addition to technical resumes, please provide countries of origin, type of visas or work permits held, and explanation of their anticipated involvement level in the project, i.e., tasks to be assigned. When the proposed technology is subject to export control, these individuals, if permitted to participate, are limited to work in the public domain. Further, tasks assigned must not be capable of assimilation into an understanding of the project's overall objectives. This precludes foreign nationals from acting in key positions such as Principal Investigator, Senior Engineer, etc. Additional information may be requested during negotiations to verify foreign person's eligibility. If the proposed work is International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) Restricted or otherwise export-controlled, the information and materials provided pursuant to or resulting from that proposal are restricted under the ITAR, 22 CFR Parts 120 - 130, which controls the export of defense-related material and services, including the export of sensitive technical data. Non-U.S. citizens may perform work under an award resulting from these topics only if they are "Lawfully Admitted for Permanent Residence", as defined in 8 U.S.C. 1101(20) or are designated as "Protected Individuals" as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1324b(a)(3). If a proposal for an ITAR-restricted technology involves participation of a non-U.S. citizen who is not in one of the above two categories, the proposal may be rejected.
Glossary	Include a glossary of acronyms and abbreviations used in the proposal.

f. COST VOLUME (VOLUME 3)

Table 2: Cost Volume Description (Volume 3)	
Complete the Cost Volume as shown in the Cost Breakdown Guidance. This is accomplished by using the online cost volume form in DSIP. Some items may not apply to the proposed project. If not, do not provide information for those items. Enough information shall be provided for DAF to understand the company's plan to utilize the requested funds, i.e., the purpose, necessity, and reasonableness of each expenditure. Provide sufficient detail, as found below, regarding funds' use if the contract is awarded. The itemized listing may be placed in the "Explanatory Material" section of the on-line Cost Volume (if there is enough room) or submitted in Volume 5, *Supporting Documents*, under the "Other" dropdown option. Note: Only one (1) file can be uploaded to DSIP. Note: If no exceptions are taken to an applicant's proposal, the Government **may** make award without further communications. Therefore, the initial proposal should contain an applicant's best terms from a cost/price and technical standpoint.	
Direct Labor Costs	For direct costs, include substantiating information such as vendor quotes, previous orders, historical data, etc. Costs without substantiating justification should be detailed through the cost estimating process. All substantiating evidence should be included in the *Additional Cost Information* section of the Volume 5, *Supporting Documents*. If selected for award, the Government may require further documentation to substantiate costs. Identify key personnel by name, if possible, or by labor category if specific names are not available. The number of hours, labor overhead and/or fringe benefits, and actual hourly rates for each individual are required.
Direct Material Costs	Provide an itemized list, including types, quantities, price, and, when appropriate, purpose, for materials, parts, and supplies. If proposing direct material, justification information, including vendor quotes, historical costs, etc., can be included as *Supplemental Cost Information* in Volume 5, *Supporting Documents*.
Other Direct Costs	
This category of costs includes specialized services such as machining or milling, special testing or analysis, and/or cost incurred in obtaining temporary use of specialized equipment. Proposals, which include leased hardware, must provide an adequate lease vs. purchase justification or rationale. If proposing other direct costs, additional information can be included as *Supplemental Cost Information* in Volume 5, *Supporting Documents*.	

Travel	Include travel costs in *Other Direct Costs*. Travel costs must relate to the needs of the project. Break out travel cost by trip, number of travelers, airfare, per diem, lodging, etc. The number of trips required, as well as the destination and purpose of each should be included. Recommend budgeting at least one (1) trip to the Air Force location managing the contract. Estimation of travel costs need not be an overly onerous exercise, and actual travel cost may differ from your proposed travel. This information allows the government Contracting Officer (CO) to ensure travel costs are not excessive.
Subcontracts	Include subcontractor/consultant costs in *Other Direct Costs*. Involvement of university or other consultants in the planning and/or research stages of the project may be appropriate. If so, describe in detail and include information in the Cost Volume. The proposed total of all consultant fees, facility leases or usage fees, and other subcontract or purchase agreements may not exceed one-third the total contract price or cost, unless otherwise approved in writing by the CO. Support subcontract costs with copies of the subcontract agreements. The supporting agreement documents must adequately describe the work to be performed. At a minimum, an applicant must include a Statement of Work (SOW) with a corresponding detailed Cost Volume for each planned subcontract.
Consultants	Provide a separate agreement letter for each consultant. The letter should briefly state what service or assistance will be provided, the number of hours required, and the hourly rate.
Special Tooling/Test Equipment/Material	The inclusion of equipment and materials will be carefully reviewed relative to need and the appropriateness of the work proposed. The purchase of special tooling and test equipment must, in the opinion of the Contracting Officer, be advantageous to the Government and relate directly to the specific effort. Such items may include innovative instrumentation and/or automatic test equipment. Title to property furnished or funded by the Government will be vested with the AF, unless determined that title transfer to the contractor is more cost effective than equipment recovery by the Government.

g. COMPANY COMMERCIALIZATION REPORT (VOLUME 4)

Completion of the CCR as Volume 4 of the proposal submission in DSIP is required. Please refer to the DoD Program CSO for full details on this requirement. Information contained in the CCR will not be considered by DAF during proposal evaluations.

h. SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS (VOLUME 5)

Table 3: Supporting Documents (Volume 5)
This volume is used to submit additional documentation supporting the Technical Volume (Volume 2) and the Cost Volume (Volume 3).

Please note that files submitted as part of Volume 5 have a file size limit of 5 MB. When combining .pdf documents, ensure digital signatures are not stripped.
Documents Required at Proposal Submission
~~**Attachment 1:** Phase I Proposal Template~~
Attachment 2: SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement Certification
Attachment 3: SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement Lifecycle Certification
Required (if applicable) Documents
Attachment 4: Identification and Assertion of Use, Release, or Disclosure Restrictions
Attachment 5: Certification for SBIR Applicants that are Majority-Owned by Multiple Venture Capital Operating Companies, Hedge Funds, or Private Equity Firms
Recommended at Proposal Submission NIST SP 800-171 Assessment Requirements Applicants are required to implement NIST SP 800-171 in accordance with DFARS 252.204-7019 to receive a contract award. Applicants shall have a current basic assessment (see DFARS 252.204-7020, NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessment Requirements) for each covered contractor information system that is relevant to the offer and/or contract. DAF does not require the basic assessment to be completed nor submitted with its proposal under the applicable solicitation to which they are applying. The NIST assessment requirements are contained in the CSO to provide applicants with advanced notice that should their application be Selected that they SHALL meet these requirements herein prior to a contract being awarded. Failure to meet the requirements may lead to disqualification during contract negotiations. DAF encourages all applicants with current SBIR/STTR funded contracts to follow the instructions below to obtain a Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE) account to meet the NIST requirement within the Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) module in PIEE. The Basic, Medium, and High NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessments are described in the NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessment Methodology located at https://dodprocurementtoolbox.com/site-pages/cybersecurity-policy-regulations. In accordance with DFARS 252.204-7020, the SBC shall provide access to its facilities, systems, and personnel necessary for the Government to conduct a Medium or High NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessment, as described in NIST SP 800-171 DoD Assessment Methodology, linked above. **Instructions for Completing NIST SP 800-171 Basic Assessment** ● To complete and obtain a basic self-assessment score, go to www.projectsprectrum.io. ● Login or register to begin the assessment ● Once logged in, scroll to the bottom and click on "NIST 800-171" ● Upon completion, save the document, as you will need your self-assessment score and date submitted ● Submit NIST SP 800-171 in one of two ways: ○ **Preferred:** All applicants should obtain a Procurement Integrated Enterprise Environment (PIEE) account and submit their firm's assessment directly to the Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) module in PIEE. Failure to ensure your company's score is published in PIEE's SPRS module by **August 18, 2025**, as well as failure to provide any additional requested information, as specified in DFARS 252.204-7019, may result in disqualification.

DAF recommends early completion and submission of this information. Instructions on creating a PIEE/SPRS account can be found at https://www.sprs.csd.disa.mil/pdf/NISTSP800-171QuickEntryGuide.pdf. **Alternate:** Email WEBPTSMH.fct@navy.mil and include the required information specified in DFARS 252.204-7019(d)(1). Confirm with the email address above that your company's NIST SP 800-171 self-assessment score has been posted to the SPRS module in the PIEE.	
Documents Acceptable for Inclusion in Volume 5, Supporting Documents	
Supplemental Cost Information	This document is used to provide additional cost information to augment the Cost Volume (Volume 3) provided in the online form. The Supplemental Cost Information detail must be adequate to enable Department of the Air Force personnel to determine the purpose, necessity, and reasonableness of each cost element provided in the Cost Volume (Volume 3). For significant costs, e.g. large number of hours, very high hourly wages, substantial labor overhead/fringe rates, etc., provide justification. A helpful resource for determining average rates is https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_nat.htm.
Direct Material Costs Supporting Documentation	See Table 2, *Cost Volume Description (Volume 3)*.
Travel Included in Other Direct Costs	Include the sources of estimated costs for flights, lodging, meals, and ground transportation. A useful resource for this section is https://www.gsa.gov/travel.
Special Tooling/Test Equipment Costs	See Table 2, *Cost Volume Description (Volume 3)*.
Subcontractor Agreements	If the applicant intends to utilize consultants, subcontractors, academia, etc., describe the relationship in detail, including information in the Cost Volume (Volume 3). The proposed total of all consultant fees, facility leases/usage fees, and/or other subcontract or purchase agreements, may not exceed one-half of the total contract price/cost, unless otherwise approved in writing by the government Contracting Officer. Provide copies of subcontract agreements. The supporting agreement documents must adequately describe the work to be performed. At a minimum, an applicant must include a Statement of Work (SOW) with a corresponding detailed Cost Volume (Volume 3) for each planned subcontract.
Copies of Consultant Agreements	Provide a separate agreement letter for each consultant. The letter should briefly state the tasks to be provided, hours required, and hourly rate. Some SBCs seek assistance from subcontractors or consultants to determine their solution's feasibility for a specific DoD customer. If working with a customer discovery firm like this, the associated agreement is required to be included in the proposal.
Facilities/Equipment	Describe instrumentation and/or physical/digital facilities necessary and available to carry out the proposed effort. Justify equipment to be purchased, including in 'Additional Cost Information,' as necessary. State whether proposed performance locations meet

	federal, state, and local government environmental laws and regulations for airborne emissions, waterborne effluents, external radiation levels, outdoor noise, solid/bulk waste disposal practices, toxic/hazardous material handling/storage, and others, as identified.
Indirect Costs	The proposal should identify the specific rates used and allocation bases to which they are applied. Provide proposed rates and applications per FY throughout the anticipated performance period. Do not propose composite rates.
Resumes of Key Personnel	Full resumes, including a publications list, for the Primary Investigator and other key technical personnel shall be included.
Non-Proprietary Work Plan	Provide a standalone, complete, non-proprietary work plan, free of proprietary markings. Failure to provide this document will necessitate a request for revision and may delay contract award. Note: this document is separate from the Work Plan Outline contained in Volume 2.
DD Form 2345	International Traffic in Arms (ITAR) / Export Administration Regulations (EAR) Certification: For proposals whose solutions fall under export-controlled regulations (either ITAR or EAR), a copy of the certified DD Form 2345, *Militarily Critical Technical Data Agreement*, or evidence of application submission, must be included. The form, instructions, and FAQs may be found at the United States/Canada Joint Certification Program website, http://www.dla.mil/HQ/InformationOperations/Offers/Products/LogisticsApplications/JCP/DD 2345Instructions.aspx. Approval of the DD Form 2345 will be verified if the proposal is chosen for award.
Allocation of Rights	If subcontracting to a research institution or other organization, the SBC may wish to complete an allocation of rights agreement. This is not required for SBIR awards but may be used at the company's discretion. Example: https://rt.cto.mil/wp-content/uploads/STTR-Model-Agreement-for-the-Allocation-of-Rights.pdf
Data Rights Assertions	If an applicant plans to submit assertions IAW DFARS 252.227-7018 or similar award term, those assertions must be identified, and restrictions MUST be included in the proposal submission in Volume 5. Award cannot be executed until assertions are approved or mutually agreed-upon during negotiations. Any SBIR/STTR data delivered by the Awardee, and in which the Awardee intends to limit the federal government's rights to SBIR/STTR data rights, must be delivered with restrictive markings. The federal government assumes no liability for the access, use, modification, reproduction, release, performance, display, disclosure, or distribution of SBIR/STTR data without markings. The Awardee or its subcontractors shall conspicuously and legibly mark all such SBIR/STTR data with the appropriate legend, placed on each page of the SBIR/STTR data.
Research Involving Human Subjects (RIHS)	Proposals that implicate RIHS must include a detailed description of the research plan, study population, risks, and benefits of study

	participation, recruitment and consent process, data collection and data analysis.

i. FRAUD, WASTE, AND ABUSE (FWA) TRAINING (VOLUME 6)

Fraud, Waste and Abuse training material can be found in the Volume 6 section of the proposal submission module in DSIP and must be thoroughly reviewed once per year to proceed with proposal submission. Additional details are addressed in the DoD SBIR Program CSO.

j. DISCLOSURES OF FOREIGN AFFILIATIONS OR RELATIONSHIPS TO FOREIGN COUNTRIES (VOLUME 7)

Small business concerns must complete the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries webform in Volume 7 of the DSIP proposal submission. Please be aware that the Disclosures of Foreign Affiliations or Relationships to Foreign Countries WILL NOT be accepted as a PDF Supporting Document in Volume 5 of the DSIP proposal submission. Do not upload any previous versions of this form to Volume 5. For additional details, please refer to the DoD Program CSO.

k. MISCELLANEOUS

i. Common Disqualifiers

The following are common reasons for which proposals are disqualified. It is not a comprehensive list of potential reasons for disqualification but is meant to be instructive. Applicants shall read ALL solicitation instructions to ensure compliance.

- Minimum Performance Percentage of Work is not allocated properly.
- Work, as proposed, does not meet the definition of R/R&D required for funding.
- Proposal submitted beyond deadline. In the event of technical difficulty, contact DSIP Help Desk immediately at DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com.
- Proposal submitted exceeds the maximum SBIR funding amount ($75,000.00)
- Proposal submitted exceeds the maximum specified duration (90 calendar days).
- Proposal claims data rights assertions without including a *Data Rights Assertions* table (as found in DFARS 252.227-7018) in Volume 5, Supporting Documents, of the proposal.
- Failure to submit Volume 2 using the mandatory proposal template.

ii. DAF SBIR/STTR Open Topic Objectives

The DAF SBIR/STTR Program's objectives include stimulating technological innovation, strengthening the small business role in meeting DoD research, development, test, and evaluation (RDT&E) needs, fostering and encouraging small businesses in technological innovation, and increasing commercial application of DoD-supported RDT&E results.

The DAF SBIR/STTR Program follows the policies and practices of the Small Business Administration (SBA) SBIR/STTR Policy Directive (3 May 2023): https://www.sbir.gov/sites/default/files/SBA%20SBIR_STTR_POLICY_DIRECTIVE_May2023.pdf.

iii. Proposal Review Information

The Air Force anticipates all proposal reviews will be complete, selection decisions made, and notification letters sent within approximately 90 calendar days of solicitation close. Please refrain from contacting the DAF for proposal status before that time.

iv. Proposal Status and Feedback

The PI and Corporate Official indicated on the Proposal Coversheet will be notified by email regarding proposal selection or non-selection. The small business will receive one (1) notification for each proposal submitted. Please note the referenced proposal number and read each notification carefully. If changes occur to the company mail or email addresses or points of contact after proposal submission, the information must be provided to the DAF via AF SBIR/STTR One Help Desk at DoDSBIRSupport@reisystems.com.

Feedback will be provided to applicants with proposals designated as "Not Selected". The feedback provided with the "Not Selected" notice will constitute the only feedback applicants will receive. Requests for additional feedback will not receive a response. The DAF anticipates fulfilling feedback requests using automated standardized language associated with peer review/technical evaluation scores. As such, applicants will not be provided with selection decision documentation nor will feedback documents constitute selection documentation. Note: Feedback is not the same as a FAR Part 15 debriefing.

Acquisitions under this solicitation are awarded via "other competitive procedures" IAW DFARS 206.102-70. Therefore, applicants are neither entitled to nor will they be provided FAR Part 15 debriefs.

v. Use of Support Contractors for the DAF SBIR Program

Proposals may be handled for administrative purposes only by support contractors, including APEX, Oasis Systems, Riverside Research, Peerless Technologies, HPC- COM, Mile Two, MTSI, Reef Systems, Ernst & Young, Wright Brothers Institute, Parallax, TEC Solutions, Inc. and MacB (an Alion Company). In addition, only Government employees and technical personnel from Federally Funded Research and Development Centers (FFRDCs) MITRE and Aerospace Corporation working under contract to provide technical support to AF Life Cycle Management Center and Space and Missiles Centers may evaluate proposals. All support contractors are bound by appropriate non-disclosure agreements. Contact the Air Force SBIR/STTR Contracting Officer (Daniel.Brewer.13@us.af.mil) with concerns regarding the listed contractors.

l. **AFX255-PCSO1** TITLE: Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear Air Force Stakeholder Need

OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas:
Advanced Computing and Software; Advanced Materials; Biotechnology; Directed Energy (DE); Energy Resilience; Future Generation Wireless Technology (FutureG); Human-Machine Interfaces; Hypersonics; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems; Integrated Sensing and Cyber; Microelectronics; Quantum Science; Space Technology; Trusted AI and Autonomy

Objectives:
This Department of the Air Force (DAF) topic seeks technologies for transition into the United States Air Force (USAF). This topic is offered in partnership with AFWERX.

This topic seeks innovative, commercial technologies proposed to create new Air Force solutions or potential new capabilities fulfilling requirements, closing capability gaps, or providing potential technological advancements. The topic is seeking varying technical/scientific approaches and/or varying and new technologies for transition into the DAF. This topic may result in the award of prototype projects, which include not only commercially available technologies fueled by commercial or strategic investment, but also concept demonstrations, pilots, and agile development activities improving commercial technologies, existing Government-owned capabilities, or concepts for broad Defense applications. The Government reserves the right to award a contract or an Other Transactions for any purpose, to include a prototype, under this topic. This program solicitation is intended for information purposes and reflects current planning. If there is any inconsistency between the information contained herein and the terms of any resulting SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement, the terms of the Funding Agreement are controlling.

Primary objectives of this topic include exploring innovative technology solutions applicable to both defense and non-defense markets, scaling capability, and growing the industrial base for defense. This topic seeks companies with capability to complete a feasibility study and prototype-validated concepts under accelerated Phase I and Phase II schedules. This topic is aimed at applied research and development efforts rather than “front-end” or basic Research (R)/Research & Development (R&D).

Description:
The DAF is a large and complex organization consisting of many functions, a vast majority of which have similar counterparts in the commercial sector. It is important that potential solutions have a high probability of keeping pace with technological change. Thus, solutions should be closely tied to commercial technologies and solutions supporting the proposed development. This topic is meant for non-defense commercial solutions to be adapted to meet Air Force stakeholders' needs.

Proposed technical solutions should focus on the characteristics outlined in the Evaluation Criteria section of this solicitation.

The topic is truly 'open' (agnostic of industry, technology, and problem area), but proposals for this topic should demonstrate a high probability of identifying a product-mission fit between a DAF stakeholder and the proposed adaptation of the non-defense commercial solution.

Proposals should identify which of the OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas the proposed solution addresses or otherwise reference "BLUE SKY" and include an explanation of the solution's ability to provide increased strategic capability within the context of DAF, national, and global constraints.

Additional information on OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas can be found at https://dod-critical-technology-area-roadmaps.zoiclabs.io/.

The AF SBIR Program follows the policies and practices of the Small Business Administration (SBA) SBIR/STTR Policy Directive (3 May 2023): https://www.sbir.gov/sites/default/files/SBA%20SBIR_STTR_POLICY_DIRECTIVE_May2023.pdf.

Phase I:
Determine, insofar as possible, the scientific and technical merit and feasibility of ideas appearing to have commercial potential. Validate the product-mission fit between the proposed solution and a potential Air Force stakeholder. Define a clear, immediately actionable plan with the proposed solution and the DAF customer, end-user, and TPOC.

The feasibility study should:
1. Clearly identify the potential stakeholders of the adapted solution for solving the DAF need(s).
2. Describe the pathway to integrating with DAF operations, to include how the applicant plans to accomplish core technology development, navigate applicable regulatory processes, and integrate with other relevant systems and/or processes.
3. Describe if and how the solution can be used by other Department of Defense (DoD) or governmental customers.

Phase II:
Proposals should include development, installation, integration, demonstration and/or test and evaluation of the proposed solution prototype system.

These activities should focus specifically on:
1. Evaluating the adapted solution against the proposed objectives and measurable key results.
2. Describing, in detail, how the installed solution differs from the non-defense commercial offering to solve the DAF need(s), as well as how it can be scaled for wide adoption, i.e., modified for scale.
3. Identifying the proposed solution's clear transition path, taking into account input from affected stakeholders, including but not limited to, end users, engineering, sustainment, contracting, finance, legal, and cyber security.
4. Specifying the solution's integration with other current and potential future solutions.
5. Describing the solution's sustainability, i.e., supportability. Identifying other specific DoD or governmental customers for the solution.

Phase III Dual-Use Applications:
Some solutions may go from Phase I to Phase III as soon as the product-market fit is verified. Potential Phase III awardees will transition to the adapted non-Defense commercial solution to provide expanded mission capability for a broad range of potential governmental and civilian users and alternate mission applications.

References:
1. United States Department of Defense. (2023). National Defense Science & Technology Strategy 2023.
2. United States Department of Defense. (2022). 2022 National Defense Strategy of the United States Summary.

Key Words:
Open; Other; Disruptive; Radical; Dual-Use; Commercial

m. AFX255-PCSO2 TITLE: Phase I Call for Innovative Defense-Related Dual-Purpose Technologies/Solutions with a Clear Space Force Stakeholder Need

OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas:
Advanced Computing and Software; Advanced Materials; Biotechnology; Directed Energy (DE); Energy Resilience; Future Generation Wireless Technology (FutureG); Human-Machine Interfaces; Hypersonics; Integrated Network Systems-of-Systems; Integrated Sensing and Cyber; Microelectronics; Quantum Science; Space Technology; Trusted AI and Autonomy

USSF Commercial Space Strategy Mission Areas:
Space Domain Awareness (SDA); Satellite Communications (SATCOM); Space Access, Mobility, and Logistics (SAML); Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR) – hereafter referred to as Tactical, Surveillance, Reconnaissance, and Tracking (TacSRT); Space-based Environmental Monitoring (SBEM); Cyberspace Operations; Command and Control (C2); and Positioning, Navigation, and Timing (PNT)

Objectives:
This DAF topic seeks technologies for transition into the United States Space Force (USSF). This topic is offered in partnership with SpaceWERX.

This topic seeks innovative, commercial technologies proposed to create new Space Force solutions or potential new capabilities fulfilling requirements, closing capability gaps, or providing potential technological advancements. The topic is seeking varying technical/scientific approaches and/or varying and new technologies for transition into the USSF. This topic may result in the award of prototype projects, which include not only commercially available technologies fueled by commercial or strategic investment, but also concept demonstrations, pilots, and agile development activities improving commercial technologies, existing Government-owned capabilities, or concepts for broad Defense applications. The Government reserves the right to award a contract or an Other Transactions for any purpose, to include a prototype, under this topic. This program solicitation is intended for information purposes and reflects current planning. If there is any inconsistency between the information contained herein and the terms of any resulting SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement, the terms of the Funding Agreement are controlling.

Primary objectives of this topic include exploring innovative technology solutions applicable to both defense and non-defense markets, scaling capability, and growing the industrial base for defense. This topic seeks companies with capability to complete a feasibility study and prototype-validated concepts under accelerated Phase I and Phase II schedules. This topic is aimed at applied research and development efforts rather than “front-end” or basic Research (R)/Research & Development (R&D).

Description:
The DAF is a large and complex organization consisting of many functions, a vast majority of which have similar counterparts in the commercial sector. It is important that potential solutions have a high probability of keeping pace with technological change. Thus, solutions should be closely tied to commercial technologies and solutions supporting the proposed development. This topic is meant for non-defense commercial solutions to be adapted to meet Space Force stakeholders' needs.

Proposed technical solutions should focus on the characteristics outlined in the Evaluation Criteria section of this solicitation.

The topic is truly 'open' (agnostic of industry, technology, and problem area), but proposals for this topic should demonstrate a high probability of identifying a product-mission fit between a Space Force stakeholder and the proposed adaptation of the non-defense commercial solution.

According to the USSF Commercial Space Strategy, there are eight (8) mission areas considered for commercial support: Space Domain Awareness (SDA); Satellite Communications (SATCOM); Space Access, Mobility, and Logistics (SAML); Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR) – hereafter referred to as Tactical, Surveillance, Reconnaissance, and Tracking (TacSRT); Space-based Environmental Monitoring (SBEM); Cyberspace Operations; Command and Control (C2); and Positioning, Navigation, and Timing (PNT). Additionally, the USSF will seek hybrid solutions for Space Mission Enablers, those functions that span multiple missions and are fundamental to conducting space operations. Although the USSF also performs missile warning, combat power projection, electromagnetic warfare, and nuclear detonation (NUDET) detection, the USSF is not currently seeking commercial support for these missions. Additional information on the USSF Commercial Space Strategy can be found at https://www.spaceforce.mil/Portals/2/Documents/Space%20Policy/USSF_Commercial_Space_Strategy.pdf.

Additionally, it is possible for a solution to provide a capability in a previously unconsidered area. Therefore, if an applicant feels its solution does not fit within one of the listed capabilities, it can reference the “BLUE SKY” category, including an explanation of the solution’s ability to provide increased strategic capability within the context of Air Force, Space Force, national, and global constraints. As applicable, the applicant should address the category(ies) to which the solution aligns in the Technical Volume.

Proposals should identify which of the OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas and USSF Commercial Space Strategy Mission Areas the proposed solution addresses or otherwise reference "BLUE SKY" and include an explanation of the solution's ability to provide increased strategic capability within the context of USSF, national, and global constraints.

Phase I:
Determine, insofar as possible, the scientific and technical merit and feasibility of ideas appearing to have commercial potential. It must have validated the product-mission fit between the proposed solution and a potential Space Force stakeholder. Define a clear, immediately actionable plan with the proposed solution and the USSF customer, end-user, and TPOC.

The feasibility study should:
1. Clearly identify the potential stakeholders of the adapted solution for solving the Space Force need(s).
2. Describe the pathway to integrating with USSF operations, to include how the applicant plans to accomplish core technology development, navigate applicable regulatory processes, and integrate with other relevant systems and/or processes.
3. Describe if and how the solution can be used by other Department of Defense (DoD) or governmental customers.

Phase II:
Proposals should include development, installation, integration, demonstration and/or test and evaluation of the proposed solution prototype system.

These activities should focus specifically on:
1. Evaluating the adapted solution against the proposed objectives and measurable key results.

2. Describing, in detail, how the installed solution differs from the non-defense commercial offering to solve the Space Force need(s), as well as how it can be scaled for wide adoption, i.e., modified for scale.
3. Identifying the proposed solution's clear transition path, taking into account input from affected stakeholders, including but not limited to, end users, engineering, sustainment, contracting, finance, legal, and cyber security.
4. Specifying the solution's integration with other current and potential future solutions.
5. Describing the solution's sustainability, i.e., supportability. Identifying other specific DoD or governmental customers for the solution.

Phase III Dual-Use Applications:
Some solutions may go from Phase I to Phase III as soon as the product-market fit is verified. Potential Phase III awardees will transition to the adapted non-Defense commercial solution to provide expanded mission capability for a broad range of potential governmental and civilian users and alternate mission applications.

References:
1. United States Space Force. (2024). Commander's Strategic Guidance.
2. United States Department of Defense. (2023). National Defense Science & Technology Strategy 2023.
3. United States Department of Defense. (2022). 2022 National Defense Strategy of the United States Summary.

Keywords:
Open; Other; Disruptive; Radical; Dual-Use; Commercial

n. ATTACHMENTS

Attachment 1: Phase I Proposal Template (required)

The Phase I Proposal Template can be found at https://afwerx.com/divisions/ventures/open-topic/

Attachment 2: SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement Certification (required prior to award)

Attachment 3: SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement Certification—Life Cycle Certification (required prior to award)

Attachment 4: Identification and Assertion of Use, Release, or Disclosure Restrictions (required if applicable)

Attachment 5: Certification for SBIR Applicants that are Majority-Owned by Multiple Venture Capital Operating Companies, Hedge Funds, or Private Equity Firms (required if applicable)

Attachment 6: X25.5/E Release 10 Questions and Answers

ATTACHMENT 1
PHASE I PROPOSAL TEMPLATE

The Phase I Proposal Template can be found at: **https://afwerx.com/divisions/ventures/open-topic/.**

Use of the mandatory Proposal Template for Volume 2 (Technical Volume) is strictly required. **Volume 2 submissions that do not adhere to this template will be deemed non-responsive and disqualified. The correct proposal template for this solicitation is labeled "*25.5 Release 10 - SBIR/STTR Phase I Proposal Template*" at the top of the proposal template. It is the only acceptable version for this solicitation.** The submission of Volume 2 must strictly adhere to the provided mandatory template. Non-compliance with this requirement shall render the submission non-responsive.

Do not include or embed active graphics such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media in the document.

Do not include hyperlinks or any form of active link. Information linked to the proposal in such a manner will not be considered as part of the Government's evaluation.

Font must be kept no smaller than 10-pt with at least ½-inch margins. Serif font is recommended for legibility.

Each page should include the company name, topic number, and DSIP assigned proposal number. If your platform allows, this can be added as a footer. If your platform does not have the ability to add a footer, the required information can be added to the bottom of each page.

Please note that files submitted as part of Volume 2 have a file size limit of 15 MB.

ATTACHMENT 2 (Required)
SBIR/STTR FUNDING AGREEMENT CERTIFICATION

All small businesses that are selected for award of an SBIR/STTR Funding Agreement must complete this certification at the time of award and any other time set forth in the Funding Agreement that is prior to performance of work under this award. This includes checking all of the boxes and having an authorized officer of the Awardee sign and date the certification each time it is requested.

Please read carefully the following certification statements. The Federal Government relies on the information to determine whether the business is eligible for a Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) program or Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) program award. A similar certification will be used to ensure continued compliance with specific program requirements during the life of the Funding Agreement. The definitions for the terms used in this certification are set forth in the Small Business Act, SBA regulations (13 CFR part 121), the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive and also any statutory and regulatory provisions referenced in those authorities.

If the Funding Agreement officer believes that the business may not meet certain eligibility requirements at the time of award, they are required to file a size protest with the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA), which will determine eligibility. At that time, SBA will request further clarification and supporting documentation in order to assist in the verification of any of the information provided as part of a protest. If the Funding Agreement officer believes, after award, that the business is not meeting certain Funding Agreement requirements, the agency may request further clarification and supporting documentation in order to assist in the verification of any of the information provided.

Even if correct information has been included in other materials submitted to the Federal Government, any action taken with respect to this certification does not affect the Government's right to pursue criminal, civil or administrative remedies for incorrect or incomplete information given in the certification. Each person signing this certification may be prosecuted if they have provided false information. The undersigned has reviewed, verified and certifies that (all boxes must be checked unless otherwise directed):

☐ (1) The Awardee small business concern meets the ownership and control requirements set forth in 13 CFR 121.702.

(2) If a corporation – all corporate documents(namely: articles of incorporation and any amendments, articles of conversion, by-laws and amendments, shareholder meeting minutes showing director elections, shareholder meeting minutes showing officer elections, organizational meeting minutes, all issued stock certificates, stock ledger, buysell agreements, stock transfer agreements, voting agreements, and documents relating to stock options, including the right to convert non-voting stock or debentures into voting stock) must evidence that the corporation meets the ownership and control requirements set forth in 13 CFR 121.702. (Check one box).

☐ Yes

☐ N/A (Explain why N/A)

(3) If a partnership, the partnership agreement evidences that it meets the ownership and control requirements set forth in 13 CFR 121.702. (Check one box)

☐ Yes

☐ N/A (Explain why N/A)

(4) If a limited liability company – the articles of organization and any amendments, and operating agreement and amendments, evidence that it meets the ownership and control requirements set forth in 13 CFR 121.702. (Check one box).

☐ Yes

☐ N/A (Explain why N/A)

(5) The birth certificates, naturalization papers, or passports show that any individuals it relies upon to meet the eligibility requirements are U.S. citizens or permanent resident aliens in the United States. (Check one box)

☐ Yes

☐ N/A (Explain why N/A)

☐ (6) The Awardee business concern has no more than 500 employees, including the employees of its Affiliates.

☐ (7) SBA has not issued a size determination currently in effect finding that this business concern exceeds the 500 employee size standard.

(8) During the performance of the award, the Principal Investigator/Project Manager will spend more than one half of his/her time (based on a 40 hour workweek) as an employee of the Awardee (or Research Institution – STTR only) or has requested and received a written deviation from this requirement from the Funding Agreement officer. (Check one box)

☐ Yes

☐ Deviation approved in writing by Funding Agreement officer: _____%

(9) All Essentially Equivalent Work, or a portion of the work, proposed under this project (check applicable line):

☐ **Has not** been submitted for funding to this Agency or another Federal Agency

☐ **Has** been submitted for funding to this Agency or another Federal agency **but has not been funded** under any other grant, contract, subcontractor, or other transaction.

☐ A portion has been funded by another grant, contract, or subcontract as described in detail in the proposal and approved in writing by the Funding Agreement Officer.

(10) During performance of award, the Awardee will perform the applicable percentage of work unless a deviation from this requirement is approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (check applicable line and fill in if needed):

☐ SBIR Phase I: at least two-thirds (66 2/3%) of the research

☐ SBIR Phase II: at least half (50%) of the research

☐ STTR Phase I or Phase II: STTR Phase I and Phase II: at least forty percent (40%) of the research.

Deviation approved in writing by the Funding Agreement Officer (SBIR ONLY):

_____%

(11) During performance of award, the R/R&D will be performed in the United States unless a deviation is approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (check one box).

☐ Yes

☐ Waiver has been granted

☐ (12) During performance of award, the R/R&D will be performed at the Awardee's facilities by the Awardee's employees, except as otherwise indicated in the SBIR/STTR application and approved in the Funding Agreement.

(13) The SBIR awardee has registered itself on SBA's database as majority-owned by venture capital operating companies, hedge funds, or private equity firms (check one box):

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ N/A (explain why N/A):

(14) The SBIR Awardee is a Covered Small Business Concern (a Small Business Concern that: (a) was not majority-owned by multiple venture capital operating companies (VCOCs), hedge funds, or private equity firms on the date on which it submitted an application in response to an SBIR solicitation; and (b) on the date of the SBIR award, which is made more than 9 months after the closing date of the solicitation, is majority-owned by multiple venture capital operating companies, hedge funds, or private equity firms). (Check one box):

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ (15) I will notify the Agency immediately if all or a portion of the work authorized and funded under this award is subsequently funded by another Federal Agency.

(16) [*For STTR only*] The Small Business Concern, and not a partnering Research Institution, is exercising management direction and control of the performance of the STTR funding agreement.

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ (17) I understand that the information submitted may be given to Federal, State, and local agencies for determining violations of law and other purposes.

(18) I am an officer of the business concern authorized to represent it and sign this certification on its behalf. By signing this certification, I am representing on my own behalf, and on behalf of the business concern that the information provided in this certification, the application, and all other information submitted in connection with this application, is true and correct as of the date of submission. I acknowledge that any intentional or negligent misrepresentation of the information containe 120 certification may result in criminal, civil or administrative sanctions, including but not limited to: (1) fines, restitution and/or imprisonment under 18 U.S.C. 1001; (2) treble damages and civil penalties under the False Claims Act (31 U.S.C. 3729 et seq.); (3) double damages and civil penalties under the Program Fraud Civil Remedies Act (31 U.S.C. 3801 et seq.); (4) civil recovery of award funds, (5) suspension and/or debarment from all Federal procurement and nonprocurement transactions (FAR subpart 9.4 or 2 CFR part 180); and (6) other administrative penalties including termination of SBIR/STTR awards.

Signature	
Print Name	
Date	
Title	
Business Name	

Attachment 3 (required)
SBIR/STTR FUNDING AGREEMENT CERTIFICATION – LIFE CYCLE CERTIFICATION

All SBIR/STTR Phase I and Phase II Awardees must complete this certification at all times set forth in the Funding Agreement (see § 8(j) of the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive). This includes checking all of the boxes (unless otherwise directed) and having an authorized officer of the Awardee sign and date the certification each time it is requested.

Please read carefully the following certification statements. The Federal Government relies on the information to ensure compliance with specific program requirements during the life of the Funding Agreement. The definitions for the terms used in this certification are set forth in the Small Business Act, the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive, and also any statutory and regulatory provisions referenced in those authorities.

If the Funding Agreement officer believes that the business is not meeting certain Funding Agreement requirements, the agency may request further clarification and supporting documentation in order to assist in the verification of any of the information provided.

Even if correct information has been included in other materials submitted to the Federal Government, any action taken with respect to this certification does not affect the Government's right to pursue criminal, civil or administrative remedies for incorrect or incomplete information given in the certification. Each person signing this certification may be prosecuted if they have provided false information. The undersigned has reviewed, verified and certifies that (all boxes must be checked except where otherwise directed):

The undersigned has reviewed, verified and certifies that (all boxes must be checked except where otherwise directed):

(1) The Principal Investigator/Project Manager spent more than one half of his/her time (based on a 40 hour workweek) as an employee of the Awardee (or Research Institution – STTR only) or the Awardee has requested and received a written deviation from this requirement from the Funding Agreement officer.

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Deviation approved in writing by Funding Agreement Officer _____%

(2) All Essentially Equivalent Work, or a portion of the work, performed under this project (check the applicable box):

☐ **Has not** been submitted for funding to this Agency or another Federal Agency

☐ **Has** been submitted for funding to this Agency or another Federal agency but has not been funded under any other grant, contract, subcontract or other transaction.

☐ A portion has been funded by another grant, contract, or subcontract as described in detail in the proposal and approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer.

(3) Upon completion of the award, the Awardee will have performed the applicable percentage of work, unless a deviation from this requirement is approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (check the applicable line and fill in if needed):

☐ SBIR Phase I: at least two-thirds (66 2/3%) of the research

☐ SBIR Phase II: at least half (50%) of the research

☐ STTR Phase I or Phase II: at least forty percent (40%) of the research

☐ Deviation approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (SBIR only): _____%

(4) The work is completed and the small business Awardee has performed the applicable percentage of work, unless a deviation from this requirement is approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (check the applicable line and fill in if needed):

☐ SBIR Phase I: at least two-thirds (66 2/3%) of the research

☐ SBIR Phase II: at least half (50%) of the research

☐ STTR Phase I or Phase II: at least forty percent (40%) of the research

☐ Deviation approved in writing by the Funding Agreement officer (SBIR only): _____%

☐ N/A because work is not completed

(5) [*For STTR only*] The Small Business Concern, and not a partnering Research Institution, is exercising management direction and control of the performance of the STTR Funding Agreement.

☐ Yes

☐ No

(6) The R/R&D is performed in the United States unless a deviation is approved in writing by the Funding Agreement Officer.

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Waiver has been granted

(7) The R/R&D is performed at the Awardee's facilities by the Awardee's employees, except as otherwise indicated in the SBIR/STTR application and approved in the Funding Agreement.

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ (8) I will notify this Agency immediately if all or a portion of the work authorized and funded under this award is subsequently funded by another Federal Agency.

☐ (9) I understand that the information submitted may be given to Federal, State, and local agencies for determining violations of law and other purposes.

I am an officer of the Awardee business concern authorized to represent it and sign this certification on its behalf. By signing this certification, I am representing on my own behalf, and on behalf of the business concern, that the information provided in this certification, the application, and all other information submitted in connection with the award, is true and correct as of the date of submission. I acknowledge that any intentional or negligent misrepresentation of the information contained in this certification may result in criminal, civil or administrative sanctions, including but not limited to: (1) fines, restitution and/or imprisonment under 18 U.S.C. 1001; (2 124 damages and civil penalties under the False Claims Act (31 U.S.C. 3729 et seq.); (3) double damages and civil penalties under the Program Fraud Civil Remedies Act (31 U.S.C. 3801 et seq.); (4) civil recovery of award funds, (5) suspension and/or debarment from all Federal procurement and nonprocurement transactions (FAR subpart 9.4 or 2 CFR part 180); and (6) other administrative penalties including termination of SBIR/STTR awards.

Signature	
Print Name	
Date	
Title	
Business Name	

ATTACHMENT 4
IDENTIFICATION AND ASSERTION OF USE, RELEASE, OR DISCLOSURE RESTRICTIONS (required if applicable)

Technical Data or Computer Software to be Furnished with Restrictions*	Basis for Assertion**	Asserted Rights Category***	Name of Person Asserting Restrictions

*For technical data (other than computer software documentation) pertaining to items, components, or processes developed at private expense, identify both the deliverable technical data and each such item, component, or process. For computer software or computer software documentation identify the software or documentation.
** Generally, development at private expense, either exclusively or partially, is the only basis for asserting restrictions. For technical data, other than computer software documentation, development refers to development of the item, component, or process to which the data pertain. The Government's rights in computer software documentation generally may not be restricted. For computer software, development refers to the software. Indicate whether development was accomplished exclusively or partially at private expense. If development was not accomplished at private expense, or for computer software documentation, enter the specific basis for asserting restrictions.
*** Enter asserted rights category (e.g., government purpose license rights from a prior contract, rights in SBIR data generated under another contract, limited, restricted, or government purpose rights under this or a prior contract, or specially negotiated licenses).
**** Corporation, individual, or other person, as appropriate.

Signature	
Print Name	
Title	

***** Under the first column, only identify technical data and computer software/documentation that will be **delivered** with restrictions. Further, for each technical data item identified in the first column, include the applicable CLIN that it will be delivered under (e.g. CLIN 0002). For **deliverable** non-commercial software, identify the applicable CLIN (e.g. CLIN 0001).)

ATTACHMENT 5
CERTIFICATION FOR SBIR APPLICANTS THAT ARE MAJORITY-OWNED BY MULTIPLE VENTURE CAPITAL OPERATING COMPANIES, HEDGE FUNDS, OR PRIVATE EQUITY FIRMS (Required if applicable)

Any small business that is majority-owned by multiple venture operating companies (VCOCs), hedge funds, or private equity firms and is submitting an application for an SBIR Funding Agreement must complete this certification prior to submitting an application. This includes checking all of the boxes and having an authorized officer of the Applicant sign and date the certification each time it is requested.

Please read carefully the following certification statements. The Federal Government relies on the information to determine whether the business is eligible for a Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) program award and meets the specific program requirements during the life of the Funding Agreement. The definitions for the terms used in this certification are set forth in the Small Business Act, SBA regulations (13 CFR part 121), the SBIR/STTR Policy Directive and also any statutory and regulatory provisions referenced in those authorities.

If the Funding Agreement officer believes that the business may not meet certain eligibility requirements at the time of award, he/she is required to file a size protest with the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA), which will determine eligibility. At that time, SBA will request further clarification and supporting documentation in order to assist in the verification of any of the information provided as part of a protest. If the Funding Agreement officer believes, after award, that the business is not meeting certain Funding Agreement requirements, the agency may request further clarification and supporting documentation in order to assist in the verification of any of the information provided.

Even if correct information has been included in other materials submitted to the Federal Government, any action taken with respect to this certification does not affect the Government's right to pursue criminal, civil or administrative remedies for incorrect or incomplete information given in the certification. Each person signing this certification may be prosecuted if they have provided false information.

The undersigned has reviewed, verified, and certifies that (all boxes must be checked):

(1) ☐ The Applicant is NOT more than 50% owned by a single VCOC, hedge fund, or private equity firm.

(2) ☐ The Applicant is more than 50% owned by multiple domestic business concerns that are VCOCs, hedge funds, or private equity firms.

(3) ☐ I have registered with SBA at www.SBIR.gov as a business that is majority-owned by multiple VCOCs, hedge funds or private equity firms.

(4) ☐ I understand that the information submitted may be given to Federal, State, and local agencies for determining violations of law and other purposes.

(5) ☐ All the statements and information provided in this form and any documents submitted are true, accurate, and complete. If assistance was obtained in completing this form and the supporting documentation, I have personally reviewed the information and it is true and accurate. I understand that, in general, these statements are made for the purpose of determining eligibility for an SBIR Funding Agreement and continuing eligibility.

(6) ☐ I understand that the certifications in this document are continuing in nature. Each SBIR Funding Agreement for which the small business submits an offer or application or receives an award constitutes a restatement and reaffirmation of these certifications.

(7) ☐ I understand that I may not misrepresent status as small business obtain a contract under the Act; or 2) obtain any benefit under a provision of Federal law that references the SBIR program.

(8) ☐ I am an officer of the business concern authorized to represent it and sign this certification on its behalf. By signing this certification, I am representing on my own behalf, and on behalf of the SBIR Applicant or Awardee, that the information provided in this certification, the application, and all other information submitted in connection with this application, is true and correct as of the date of submission. I acknowledge that any intentional or negligent misrepresentation of the information contained in this certification may result in criminal, civil or administrative sanctions, including but not limited to: (1) fines, restitution and/or imprisonment under 18 U.S.C. 1001; (2) treble damages and civil penalties under the False Claims Act (31 U.S.C. 3729 et seq.); (3) double damages and civil penalties under the Program Fraud Civil Remedies Act (31 U.S.C. 3801 et seq.); (4) civil recovery of award funds, (5) suspension and/or debarment from all Federal procurement and nonprocurement transactions (FAR subpart 9.4 or 2 CFR part 180); and (6) other administrative penalties including termination of SBIR/STTR awards

Signature	
Print Name	
Title	
Business Name	

Attachment 6: X25.5/E Release 10 Questions and Answers

The DAF provides this attachment for general informational purposes only. This attachment does not purport to, nor does it, modify any other solicitation terms and provisions. The following questions represent commonly-asked questions, and may not conform to specific individual questions received by or answered by the DAF.

General SBIR/STTR Questions

1. **Can we engage in a joint venture to bring multiple capabilities for a solution?** Joint ventures are allowed, however ***all*** parties of the joint venture must meet the program's eligibility requirements.

2. **Are there any security clearances required?** The SBIR/STTR program itself does not require security clearances. Specific technologies may trend toward classification, in which case security clearances may be required.

3. **Can the SBIR/STTR be used for both prototype development and clinical testing?** SBIR/STTR funding can be used for prototype development, including clinical testing. As clinical testing likely involves Human Subjects Research (HSR), your small business would need to follow all federal, DoD, and DAF regulations related to HSR. For more information visit: the SBA HSR Tutorial: https://www.sbir.gov/tutorials/animal-human-subjects-protection/tutorial-1 and the Air Force Research Laboratory Human Research Protection Official (HRPO) information link: https://www.afrl.af.mil/Portals/90/Documents/711/AFRL_HRPP%20Info%20Sheet%20DoD%20Supported%20Human%20Research%20FINAL%202024_03_28.pdf?ver=KdOLeBKaLkMInWZQOHvuRA%3d%3d

4. **Can an American dual citizen be the principal investigator of a proposal? What about other foreign entities that are collaborators with our company?** All dual citizens should be included in the "Foreign Persons" section, the Air Force needs to know that for data collection purposes and as part of the holistic security reviews that the DAF undertakes. Foreign persons are not allowed to act in key positions such as the principal investigator if the proposed technology is subject to export control restrictions.

5. **Can we submit a Letter(s) of Support?** Letters of Support are optional. It is completely up to the applicant to submit letters of support for their proposal as it sees fit. Please refer to the solicitation for all proposal requirements, and specifically refer the evaluation criteria to determine whether letters of support would be relevant to evaluation criteria.

6. **Is it possible to book an informational with you?** The DAF is not able to book one-on-one sessions, please see the solicitation for where to direct questions, visit the AFWERX website, attend AFWERX AMAs, see AFWERX FAQs, etc. for more information.

7. **What is considered "front end research?"** DAF uses this phrasing as basic research which is looking to expand a theoretical knowledge rather than applying it in RDT&E.

8. **Can submit a STTR for AF and a SBIR for SF in the same solicitation cycle?** Yes, but you may not be awarded for essentially equivalent work. Applicants are required to provide information as part of their Volume 1 (Cover Sheet) submission that attests whether the proposal is essentially equivalent to any other proposal submitted or funded by the Government.

9. **Can a small business apply to an SBIR as a prime and also serve as a subcontractor on another small businesses SBIR that is within the same topic?** Yes.

10. **Is it possible to apply as a subcontractor for a non-US company?** No. Note the applicant and awardee must be owned in majority part by either U.S. citizens or lawful permanent residents, so a non-U.S. company would not be eligible to receive a SBIR/STTR award.

11. **Are there any other references for Space Force needs other than the USSF Commercial Space Strategy LOE2?** Best reference will be the USSF Commercial Space Strategy.

12. **To be explicit, can a dual citizen (with US as country of origin) be the PI?** Yes. Note that the DAF does ask applicants to disclose the identity of dual citizens, but this is not used to evaluate basic eligibility.

13. **If there is a SBIR D2P2 pending a decision (from the June due date cycle) -- is there a risk of submitting this Phase 1?** The DAF cannot advise on business risk, but proposals cannot be awarded for essentially equivalent work.

General Open Topic Phase I Questions

14. **We received a lot of questions regarding finding a customer/stakeholder or if a customer memorandum is needed for a Phase I. So, is that needed and how does the small business find them?** A committed customer is not required for Phase I. For more information on navigating the DoD, please see our Phase I FAQ under "Useful Resources" https://afwerx.com/wp-content/uploads/20250702_Ventures_Open_Topic_Phase_I_FAQs_update_CLEARED_AFRL-2025-3235.pdf

15. **What is the minimum TRL required for the start and end of a Phase I?** While there is no minimum Technology Readiness Level identified for a Phase I Open Topic, this topic is aimed at applied research and development efforts rather than "front-end" or basic Research (R)/Research & Development (R&D). Which may indicate a higher TRL. Your Phase II will be in the prototyping phase and that should be reflected in the TRL.

16. **Are Phase I winners eligible for D2P2?** Yes, SBCs that have received a Phase I in the past may submit a D2P2. However, D2P2s must have a Phase I-like feasibility study that was accomplished

without any SBIR/STTR funding. You may not use a SBIR or STTR Phase I effort for your D2P2.

17. **What is the path to a Phase II (or Phase III) contract if you win a Phase I Open Topic?** Once awarded, there are several resources available to our Phase I awardees to gain a customer and progress through the SBIR/STTR program including colliders and SAGE fellows.

18. **What defines "clear stakeholder" for phase I, is this similar to Customer Memorandum for phase II?** This topic is meant for non-defense commercial solutions to be adapted to meet Air Force stakeholders' needs. This does not need customer buy-in or a Customer Memorandum, but rather demonstrate a high probability of identifying a product-mission fit between a DAF stakeholder and the proposed adaption of the non-defense commercial solution.

19. **In the Transition Plan, are we supposed to name a DAF customer?** In the transition plan, you'll need to briefly describe how your proposed solution could integrate with the existing efforts of your ***proposed*** DAF customer.

20. **What is the definition of a DAF customer?** In respect to a Phase I, the customer is the ***proposed*** organization that could be responsible for acquiring the solution on the end-user's behalf and supports the acquisition or fielding of the capability.

21. **If we have a DoD Customer interested in our proposed research, what should we have from them; what should we let them know?** If you are not ready for a Direct-to-Phase II with a customer memorandum and the prototyping phase, you may still choose to apply to a Phase I. Your DoD Customer can write a Letter of Support. Note that letters of support are not required.

22. **How to handle highly secret elements of the subject of the proposal?** If proprietary information, which constitutes a trade secret, commercial or financial information, is included, it should be marked. Proprietary information will be treated in confidence, to the extent permitted by law. Secret elements in terms of national security should NOT be included in your proposal.

23. **There were a few questions regarding Essentially equivalent work - meaning can we get a Phase I for work that was previously funded or on contact with the DAF or another government agency?** No, essentially equivalent work is NOT allowed. Small businesses must certify that the work being done under the award is not essentially equivalent to other federally funded awards made to the company.

24. **Is this a stepwise application process that begins with Phase I and progresses to Phase II?** Those awarded a Phase I, and meet the contract requirements, will be invited to submit to a Follow on Phase II.

25. **Could you please clarify the official ceiling and period of performance for a Phase I STTR in the AFWERX / SpaceWERX 25.E Open Topic?** The SBIR maximum is $75k, and the STTR maximum is $110k. The maximum PoP is 90 days for both.

26. **STTR -what % of budget for Research Institution?** Not less than 30% of total R/R&D.

27. **If we have a sponsor, where do you mention your technical sponsor in the application?** Letters of Support are optional. It is completely up to the SBC to submit their proposal as they see fit. Please refer to the solicitation for all proposal requirements.

28. **What will be the POP and amount for the Phase II program that follows these Phase I's? -** Open Topic Phase II Period of Performance will be 21 months.

29. **How do we find specific customers in Air Force? How do we reach out to them? And how much communication is required before Phase 1 submission. -** Communications before Phase I are not required; Finding your customer occurs in P1 and the P1 Program Team will share resources during your award's POP.

30. **Is there any difference between the Phase I template for SBIR and STTR PI?** It is the same template for both SBIR and STTR. However, there are call outs when elements are needed for just STTR.

31. **If you are already working/talking to a DAF partner, does that disqualify you?** No, but ensure that a Phase I is appropriate. If the proposed technology has already reached demonstrated feasibility, then a Phase I award may not be suitable for that proposed technology.

32. **What is the goal of a Phase I?** The feasibility study is conducted during Phase I with a 3-month period of performance where the small business works to identify its Air Force end user (warfighter) and customer (program office) with the goal of getting that Air Force end user and customer to sign a Customer Memorandum verbalizing their intent to work with the small business on transitioning their technology to warfighters.

33. **Can we go straight to Phase II if we have certain components of the system already prototyped but not integrated as a system yet ?** DAF will have future Direct-to-Phase-II (D2P2) offerings. Note that this is a Phase I-ONLY offering. For more information on D2P2s, please see AFWERX's D2P2 FAQ.

34. **We have not won a SBIR/STTR in the past, but have secured a CRADA with AFRL to co-develop our product. Given that this SBIR is for customer discovery, would we be able to mention AFRL as our potential customer/stakeholder?** Yes, you can mention them in your proposal, but note your proposal work and your accomplished and/or funded CRADA work need to be different.

35. **Once awarded a Phase I when does the Phase II proposal need to be submitted?** Successful Phase I awardees will be invited to submit to a Phase II. This is typically around 3 months after Phase I award completion.

36. **How do I find an AF customer (i.e how can I locate AF customer prospects to reach out to and discuss our project with them?** If you do not have an end-user or a customer, a great route would be to start with a Phase I. A Phase I award is a feasibility study, but also has a curriculum on outreach to find your customer and Shared Awareness through Guided Empowerment (SAGE) fellows that can help make connections to your customer and end-user.

37. **The Related Work description says, "Describe significant activities *directly* related to the proposed effort" and then at the end "Describe similar previous and parallel work *not directly* related to the proposed effort". Which is correct?** Describe significant activities directly related to the proposed effort, including any conducted by the PI, proposing firm, consultants, or others. Describe how these activities interface with the proposed project and discuss planned coordination with outside sources**.**

38. **Are we disqualified to participate in this topic if our technology is already used in the defense industry?** This is a solicitation meant for research or research and development (R/R&D). Ensure R/R&D is occurring.

39. **Are SAGE fellows available during Phase 1 submission process or only after receiving the Phase 1 award ?** The SAGE program is only available for those that receive a Phase I award.

40. **If an individual is part of two separate companies that are both submitting proposals to this solicitation, will that create a problem? i.e. they are named as personnel on two proposals.** Not necessarily, unless the individual is listed as the Principal Investigator (PI). The PI must be primarily employed at the Note, under the terms of the solicitation, full-time employment at one firm precludes full-time employment at another firm.

25.5/E Release 10 - Specific Questions

41. **Slide 7: "Attachments in the CSO may also be different so it's important to check the correct Solicitation". Which TRI / solicitation is the correct one?** SBIR: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/topics-app/?baa=DOD_SBIR_2025_P1_C5 STTR: https://www.dodsbirsttr.mil/topics-app/?baa=DOD_STTR_2025_P1_CE

42. **What certifications such as CMMC or NIST is a company required to have to participate in an AFWERX/SpaceWERX contract?** NIST Requirements can be found on page 39 of the solicitation.

43. **In the Vol 5 required docs (Table 3), the Phase I Proposal Template is included. Is this correct?** The proposal template is required as Volume 2. If it is included in Volume 5 that is not a problem, but note that only the document provided as part of Volume 2 will be evaluated.

44. **Description of the evaluation criteria, and tips on how to write a great proposal from the reviewers perspective.** The 25.5/E selection methodology and evaluation criteria can be found in the solicitation starting on page 30.

45. **Do Research Institutions need to be included in our Small Business proposal?** Performance of Work allocations need to be included as part of Volume 3.
46. **The solicitation doesn't mention letters of support as optional for volume 5. Are these acceptable? Encouraged?** Not required, but accepted and reviewed. Letters of Support are optional. It is completely up to the SBC to submit their proposal as they see fit. Please refer to the solicitation for all proposal requirements and review technical evaluation criteria to determine the relevance of letters of support to your specific proposal.

47. **Are selection notifications and feedback still expected within 90 days after the August 5 deadline?** While dates are subject to change, we are expecting contracts to be awarded in December 2025.

48. **What additional documents are needed (from the RI or submitter) for an STTR (that aren't needed for a SBIR proposal, e.g., the tech and cost volumes)? Is the only STTR specific form "Attachment 5: Contractor Certification Regarding Preaward Requirements for Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) Program"? Is a Subcontractor Agreement, or anything else needed (that isn't needed for a SBIR proposal, e.g., the tech and cost volumes)?** Review the 25.E R10 STTR P1 TRI for proposal requirements. For STTR proposals, applicants are required to submit a Contractor Certification Regarding Preaward Requirements for Small Business Technology Transfer Program (Attachment 5) and will be required to submit a written agreement between the SBC and partnering RI allocating Intellectual Property rights and rights, if any, to carry out follow-on research, development or Commercialization.

49. **How many USAF and USSF awards are anticipated?** For X25.5 Release 10, the DAF DAF anticipates 260 awards will be made. For X25.E Release 10, the DAF currently anticipates making 90 open topic awards under this topic release.

50. **Can one company submit both a USAF SBIR proposal (under AFX25E-PTCSO1) and a USSF STTR proposal (under AFX25E-PTCSO1), on 5 Aug 2025?** Yes. Applicants may submit one SBIR proposal (to either but not both of the topics offered under X25.5 Release 10) and one STTR proposal (to either but not both of the topics offered under X25.E Release 10). Since the SBIR and the STTR are distinct offerings with distinct requirements, there is no restriction.

51. **We are a US firm and have a technology from a foreign firm that we feel is a good fit for USAF. How can we apply for this AFWERX grant?** Note that all R/R&D work must be performed in the United States. This includes work performed and supply or material or other item or project requirement. Check out our website for more information including the link to submit a proposal: https://afwerx.com/divisions/ventures/open-topic/ For clarity, the funds are NOT a grant.

52. **If we already submitted a similar proposal can we submit the same/similar tech proposal again in 25.5/E?** Yes**.** The small business must certify that the work being proposed under the award is not essentially equivalent to other federally funded awards made to the company.
53. **In the key personnel section, do we only use the table or add each personnel CV in this section?** Resumes should be added in the attachments under "Volume 5 - Resumes of Key Personnel."

54. **For cost breakdown, if the company is entirely software based, what is the guidance for how to calculate the cost of proposal? Since our fixed costs are also allocated to our company's core business, is it our best estimate of incremental costs incurred by work on the proposal?** Please see "Table 2: Cost Volume Description" (Volume 3). Note that all awards made under this offering will be Firm-Fixed-Price, so applicants are required to provide enough information for the DAF to understand the company's plan to utilize the requested funds, i.e. the purpose, necessity, and reasonableness of each expenditure.

55. **Can STTR or SBIR funds be used by the SBC to pay for patent license from the research institution?** Please see "Table 2: Cost Volume Description (Volume 3). Note that for costs to be allowable, all direct costs must be attributable to, and in furtherance of, the work performed under the specific SBIR/STTR award.

56. **DSIP shows us a D2P2 option, is DAF accepting D2P2 proposals for this topic?** No.

Template

57. **Are there any restrictions on changing the colors of the tables within the template?** You may change colors.

58. **Can the font size in photo/figure captions be smaller than 10pt?** No smaller than 10 point font to ensure legibility.

59. **Can we adjust the column widths on the tables?** Yes

60. **On the proposal template, under Technical Merit Summary, when it asks to list which stage the technology is in - does this refer to the proposed solution or the existing technical baseline?** Existing

61. **In the template, do you want all the drop-down menu items to stay highlighted?** There is no preference–feel free to leave it highlighted or remove the highlight.

62. **Question: Can we copy the disclosure information into the header?** You can. The solicitation supersedes the template, and it can be either.

63. **Does the content have to stay on the designated page numbers? Can it overflow or not?** It must stay on the designated pages. Overflowing content with NOT be evaluated.

64. **For the white paper template, is it exactly 13 pages and needs to follow the TOC pages framework exactly, with the set number of pages for each section? So do you leave pages blank if there is not enough info to fill out all of the allowed pages? Similarly, what if some of the predefined sections are more than the allowed pages, is that ok or do you need to cut down the info to fit within the page limits for each section?** There should be blank pages in the event that the SBC does not need all of the designated pages, however information cannot overflow into other sections. Overflow information will not be evaluated.

65. **What font should be used in the proposal template?** We do not make any font mandatory. It should be legible and no smaller than 10 point font.

66. **Should a literature review be included as a component of the Technical Merit Summary or the Related Work section?** This can be added in the attachments under "Volume 5 - Resumes of Key Personnel."

67. **Is it intentional that page 1 with the company information only show name and proposal name?** Yes

68. **Is the page layout 8.5 by 11 or a slide deck. The solicitation say .5inch margins but not the page layout?** The template should remain on the 8.5 by 11 that it was created/downloaded.

69. **The Proposal Template instructions say to "Please ensure the first page has the "Attachment: 25.5/E Release 10" Banner." Is this the banner from the instructions page or the banner on the table of contents page?** This will be the TOC page. The instruction page should be removed before submitting.

70. **Would URL links to our company's website for additional context and information useful in the white paper?** Information outside of the text of the proposal will not be evaluated.

71. **I know there is a list of funded awards, but is there an example of a successful full proposal?** Proposals aren't shared due to proprietary information. Please refer to the proposal template.

72. **Google doesn't support the drop down menu in the template, so can we just put the answers in the template? We were able to see the options in the drop down?** You can certainly just put one of the options you found.

73. **Do you have a template for the budget or sample budget?** No

74. **Can I include a link to a short 3 min video showing how the proposed solution would work? Will the link / video be reviewed?** As stated on the instruction page, "Do NOT include or embed

active graphics such as videos, moving pictures, or other similar media in the document." Additionally, information outside of the proposal will not be evaluated/reviewed.

75. **Does the AF maintain a list of Critical Technical Areas in addition to the OSD list? When should a SB use "Blue Sky" as a topic category?** Please see the drop down list on the template and "OUSD(R&E) Critical Technology Areas.

Evaluation

76. **Can you provide feedback if we do not get chosen?** Due to the number of submissions, we are unable to give a detailed report to each small business.

77. **If your solution supports DoD process efficiency, does that count for supporting the warfighter?** Efficiency may indicate a DAF mission need.

78. **Is commercial traction compulsory?** The potential for government or private sector commercialization and benefits expected to accrue from commercialization is the third evaluation criteria.

79. **Does the Air Force have a clear object definition of "dual-purpose" that would qualify/disqualify technologies?** The classic dual use definition is technology that can be used with the government/military and also commercial/non-military markets. In the SBIR program, technology that meets defense needs across multiple government partners can also be considered "government commercial" making it a possibility to propose a solution that doesn't currently have a private sector market**.**

80. **How is a phase I for an open topic evaluated? What's the criteria?** Please see the TRI, Section C "Selection Methodology and Evaluation Criteria."

81. **The update to the "critical needs" information related to Resiliency is not up yet. Can you help us understand what is the current assessment of the need?** Please see the TRI, Section C "Selection Methodology and Evaluation Criteria."

82. **You listed Eval Criteria in order of importance with Defense Need being most important followed by Tech Merit and Commercialization. Can you elaborate on how this impacts proposal evaluations?** Please see the TRI, Section C "Selection Methodology and Evaluation Criteria."

83. **Does a recent Phase III contract count as investment for match?** The existence of Phase II and/or Phase III follow-on commitments for the subject research and funding commitments related to the subject effort or private sources may be evidence of commercialization potential.

84. **How far out in time are you willing to consider for use cases?** Please see the TRI, Section C "Selection Methodology and Evaluation Criteria."

85. **How much is cost/price weighted versus the non-cost/price factors?** All evaluation criteria, other than cost or price, when combined, are significantly more important than cost or price. Where technical evaluations are essentially equal in merit, cost and/or price will be considered in determining successful applicants.

Miscellaneous

86. **Page 9 of the DoD X25.5 CSO Preface says that uploading a revised Company Commercialization Report (CCR) will automatically reset all active proposals in DSIP from 'Submitted' to 'In Progress.' Our situation: we submitted an SBIR Phase II Open-Topic proposal in the June cycle, it's still under evaluation, and the window is now closed. We're about to build a new Phase I package for August and DSIP is prompting us to upload an updated CCR. If we replace that CCR: 1) Will DSIP flip our already-submitted Phase II proposal back to 'In Progress,' and 2) if so, does that remove it from grading because we can't re-submit after the deadline?** Applicants are encouraged to review the DSIP Job Aid for "Volume IV: Company Commercialization Report" provided here.

87. **If the technology has multiple potential applications for AF, should we mention all or focus on primary proposed use?** The DAF encourages applicants to review Table 1 and the Phase I Proposal Template.

88. **If the core technology was developed by an FFRDC, and the small business builds on top of it (productization, etc.), is this still eligible per the intention of this solicitation? (I would guess yes, given STTR, but wanted to make sure.)** Probably yes, note the answers given about Essentially Equivalent Work and the discussion of Essentially Equivalent Work.

89. **Does the fraud, waste and abuse training and certification need to be done by the person submitting the proposal in DSIP?** The FWA training must be completed by the individual designated as the Proposal Owner.

90. **Does the work product under the award remain the proposing company's IP or is it co-owned by the DAF?** All awards made under these offerings will contain the clause DFARS 252.227-7018, "Rights in Other Than Commercial Technical Data and Computer Software—Small Business Innovation Research Program and Small Business Technology Transfer Program". That clause provides all information regarding data rights for data from awards resulting from these offerings. The Government will obtain royalty-free, worldwide, nonexclusive, irrevocable license rights in technical data or other than computer software. All rights not granted by the Government will be retained by the awardee.